

MPD-2047 LOWERS POTABLE WATER NORMS, MANDATES RECYCLED WATER **P3**



'VISHWASGHAAT': CJP TO REVIEW STATUS OF CENTRE'S ASSURANCES TODAY **P9**

DON'T TAKE CINEMA TOO SERIOUSLY: YASH **P12**



No new strain of H1N1, say ICMR sources as swine flu cases rise

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 23

The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has said no new strain of H1N1 has been detected in India, as influenza cases rise in Delhi and other parts of the country, and said there is no need for panic.

ICMR sources said the influenza strains currently circulating in the country are "well matched with the vaccine strains recommended for the Northern Hemisphere". The circulating Influenza A (H1N1) pdm09 viruses belong to the A/Missouri/11/2025 (H1N1) pdm09-like strain. They are part of clade 6B.1A.5a2a, subclade D.3.1.1, and have been circulating since 2025.

Seasonal influenza, including H1N1, is generally self-limiting. Fever, cough, headache and body ache are among the common symptoms, with most people recovering with appropriate **CONTINUED ON P6**

Maintenance of ministers' official homes hits 12-yr high at Rs 92.35 cr

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 23

The upkeep of Delhi's iconic Lutyens bungalows, now nearly a century old, is becoming increasingly expensive -- annual expenditure on the renovation, furnishing and repair of the official residences of Union ministers touched a record high of Rs 92.35 crore in 2025-26, more than three times the Rs 27.47 crore in 2014-15.

Briefs

Goldy claims gang behind Nijjar killing

NEW DELHI: Gangster Goldy Brar has claimed that he and his associates were behind the killing of Khalistani terrorist Hardeep Singh Nijjar in Canada in June 2023, citing Nijjar's alleged links to a drug network and illegal weapons trade. **CONTINUED ON P6**

Search on for 22 missing sailors

BHUBANESWAR: The Indian Coast Guard and Navy on Sunday stepped up the search for 22 crew members of Panama-flagged bulk carrier MV Ocean Winner, which sank in the Bay of Bengal off the Odisha coast, officials said. The vessel had 24 crew members when it sank on Saturday. A joint operation involving three Coast Guard ships and an Indian Navy P-8I aircraft rescued two Chinese **CONTINUED ON P6**

DELAY FUELS BUZZ OVER DELIMITATION BILL

10 days on, Monsoon Session of Parl still not formally prorogued

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

Ten days after both Houses of Parliament were adjourned sine die, the Monsoon session has not yet been formally prorogued, prompting speculation that the government may be keeping the session open to facilitate the passage of a key legislation without calling a fresh session.

The Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha were adjourned sine die on August 13. Normally, Parliament is prorogued within three or four days of such an adjournment, although there have been exceptions. As of Sunday morning, no notification had been issued to formally end the Monsoon session.

The Budget session this year ended on April 18 and was prorogued two days



FILE PHOTO

later, on April 20. Under the Constitution, the President convenes and prorogues Parliament on the recommendation of the government.

The delay has fuelled speculation that the government could revive its proposed legislation to amend the women's res-

ervation law, with the aim of ensuring its implementation before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections.

The government had attempted to move the legislation during the Budget session but could not secure sufficient numbers. Opposition parties, particularly those from southern

states, had raised concerns that delimitation based on population could reduce their representation in the Lok Sabha.

In response, the government has reportedly worked on a formula that would increase the number of Lok Sabha seats for states and Union territories

by a uniform 50 per cent. There had also been suggestions that the government could seek passage of the Constitution amendment Bill after Independence Day.

The Congress on Sunday questioned why the Monsoon session had still not **CONTINUED ON P6**

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha were adjourned sine die on August 13
- » The session normally gets prorogued within three to four days after adjournment
- » No prorogation notification had been issued as of Sunday morning
- » The Budget session ended April 18 and was prorogued April 20
- » President prorogues Parliament on the government's recommendation under constitutional provisions
- » Delay has fuelled speculation over a possible delimitation-linked constitutional amendment Bill

India's talent, cost advantage can drive space sector: Modi

Assures full support to entrepreneurs



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during an interaction with Space Startup CEOs, in New Delhi **PTI**

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has called for creating a strong global reputation for India's private space sector so that people around the world see the country as a place to build careers in space research and technology.

Speaking to CEOs and founders of 20 space startups on Friday, Modi said India's cost competitiveness, large talent pool and willingness to take risks could help the country establish a strong position in the global space industry. The transcript of the interaction was released on Sunday. **CONTINUED ON P6**

Pregnant defence ministry officer dies by suicide

Parents allege harassment by husband, in-laws

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

A 30-year-old Assistant Section Officer in the Ministry of Defence died by suicide at her rented accommodation in south-west Delhi's Dwarka, following which her parents approached police alleging harassment by her husband and in-laws, officials said.

Nazia Khanam was found hanging from a ceiling fan at a flat in Bharghal village in the early hours of August 21. She had married Mohammad Azam Ali Khan on April 11, a senior police officer said.

A PCR call was received at 4.21 am at Sector 23 police station. Police reached the flat, took Khanam's body into possession and informed the Sub-Divisional Magistrate. The body was later shifted to the DDU Hospital mortuary. **CONTINUED ON P6**

THE ANNUAL BILL FOR 2025-26 WAS THE HIGHEST SINCE 2014

According to information obtained by PTI through an RTI query, the government spent Rs 547.68 crore on such works between 2014-15 and 2025-26 through the Central Public Works Department (CPWD), which executes the repairs, renovation and

maintenance works.

The data shows that the annual bill for 2025-26 was the highest since 2014, officials said, attributing it to various factors, including inflation as well as the wear and tear costs of the ageing structures set in expansive grounds in the heart of the capital. CPWD officials have, over the years, pointed to maintenance challenges such as seepage, termite infestation, ageing **CONTINUED ON P6**

SIR: Ex-envoy Navdeep Suri asked to prove citizenship

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

Former Indian diplomat Navdeep Suri, who represented India in several countries, is facing an unusual but uphill challenge back home. He was informed that his details for 2003 do not match after he submitted his documents for electoral roll revision in Punjab.

Retired Indian Foreign Service officer Navdeep

Suri has been asked to produce documents proving he is an Indian citizen.

Suri, who served as India's ambassador to the United Arab Emirates and Egypt and as high commissioner to Australia, encountered the problem during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Punjab.

The Amritsar resident retired from foreign service in 2019. In a series of posts on X, **CONTINUED ON P6**

FIRST MODULE APPROVED

'India may own space station by 2035'

MPOST BUREAU
Ahmedabad, August 23

India is working to establish its own space station by 2035, with the first module of the proposed Bharatiya Antariksha Station already approved, ISRO Chairman Dr V Narayanan said on Sunday.

Addressing the third National Space Day celebrations in Ahmedabad, Narayanan said India had expanded its space capabilities considerably since beginning its space programme 64 years ago. He said space-based services were now

HIGHLIGHT

- » The first module of Bharatiya Antariksha Station has already been approved
- » Space applications now directly serve citizens across more than 50 areas
- » These include Earth observation, remote sensing and telecommunications

» Satellite technology supports television broadcasting and tele-education services

» Space systems also aid disaster warning, mitigation and citizen safety

» Navigation, monitoring and tracking are among India's other space applications

being used in more than 50 areas that directly affect citizens.

"Today, we are celebrating the third National Space Day. The theme is very important: innovation, collaboration, and aspiring for global leader-

ship in the space sector," Narayanan said.

He listed Earth observation, remote sensing, telecommunications, television broadcasting, tele-education, disaster warning and mitigation, navigation, **CONTINUED ON P6**



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Printed and Published by, Jayakanta Kumar Sharma on behalf of Front Row Media Pvt. Ltd. and by The Indian Express Pvt. Ltd., A-8, Sector-7, Noida-201301 (U.P.) and published from First Floor, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002. Editor: Durban Ganguly, Email: editor@millenniumpost.in, Tel. No. 011-47777550, Jayakanta Kumar: Room No 115, Floor: Chatterjee International Centre, 33A, Jawaharlar Nehru Road, Kolkata 700071, West Bengal., Siliguri Office: Tachud Indian Group Zonal Office, 6-212, 2nd Floor, Office Block - City Centre, Matigara District Darrang, Pin-783410 Phone: 0353- 2576321.

MPD-2047 lowers potable water norms, mandates recycled water

Capital's planned growth to come with tighter water limits

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 23

Delhi's future urban expansion will have to operate within a tighter water budget, with DDA's new Master Plan for Delhi-2047 restricting potable water availability to a maximum of 40 gallons per capita per day (GPCD) in future planned developments and pushing greater reliance on recycled wastewater for non-potable requirements.

The provision will apply to developments in land pooling areas and Low Density Areas (LDA), where water-conservation measures will have to be incorporated at both sector-layout and building-design levels. Regeneration and Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) schemes will receive no additional water beyond prescribed norms, while the existing requirement of 60 GPCD is proposed to be brought down to 50 GPCD through design and management interventions.

As per MPD 2047 plan for Delhi Jal Board's service projects the capital's population at 3.2 crore, with potable-water demand estimated at 1,600 million gallons per day (MGD) at 50 GPCD. However, potable water for future planned developments will be restricted to 40 GPCD, or 180 litres per capita per day. "Due to limited water resources, demand



Wastewater strategy also mandates decentralised treatment with dual piping for new development

40 GPCD CAP

- » As per MPD 2047 plan for DJB's service projects the capital's population at 3.2 crore, with potable-water demand estimated at 1,600 million gallons per day (MGD) at 50 GPCD
- » However, potable water for future planned developments will be restricted to 40 GPCD, or 180 litres per capita per day
- » 'Due to limited water resources, demand for potable water has been rationalised by use of non-potable recycled water'
- » Under the proposed system, around 75 litres per capita per day required for toilet flushing in residential, non-residential developments will have to be met via treated recycled water

for potable water has been rationalised by use of non-potable recycled water," the plan states.

Under the proposed system, around 75 litres

per capita per day required for toilet flushing in residential and non-residential developments will have to be met through treated recycled water using dual-

pipng systems. Industrial processes, horticulture, gardening and agriculture will also have to rely on recycled wastewater.

The plan says dual-piping is difficult and costly to retrofit in existing developments. DDA and land-development agencies will therefore have to ensure the required infrastructure in new buildings, including land-pooling and redevelopment projects.

The wastewater strategy also mandates decentralised treatment with dual piping for new development or regeneration projects discharging over 10,000 litres a day or having plots larger than 2,000 sqm. Land-pooling sectors and LDA will have to ensure Zero Liquid Waste Discharge.

At the supply end, DJB has projected 401 MGD of additional water augmentation by 2047, taking present availability of 1,000 MGD to 1,401 MGD. The augmentation will include groundwater extraction, aquifer recharge, additional Yamuna water and upstream storage projects, including Renukaji, Lakhwar and Kishau dams.

The plan also proposes four new water treatment plants, pumping infrastructure, rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge and revival of water bodies as part of its long-term water-security strategy.

Joint Panchayat stresses culture and brotherhood

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

In an effort to preserve social unity, brotherhood and cultural traditions across rural Delhi, a joint panchayat of Bawana 52 and Palam emphasised the need to engage with the youth and discuss social and family traditions.

The highlight of the panchayat was the 'Jeevan Yagya' conducted by Deepak, a resident of Ghoga village. Palam 360 Khap chief Suren Solanki, who was also present, said preserving culture and traditions was everyone's responsibility and an important step towards social integration.

"Our elders have preserved the culture, brotherhood and social traditions of Delhi's rural villages for years. Now, the youth will have to come forward, understand these traditions and their roots, and carry them forward to the next generation," he said.

As part of the initiative, Solanki said Palam 360 will hold another panchayat in Ghoga village on September 6. The gathering is expected to draw participation from across Delhi's rural belt, comprising 360 villages.

High-risk undertrials may be shifted out of Delhi jails: CM Gupta

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 23

The Delhi government is set to introduce an inter-state prisoner transfer mechanism that could allow undertrial gangsters, organised criminals and other high-risk inmates lodged in the capital's jails to be shifted to prisons in other states.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the "move is aimed at strengthening prison security, curbing organised crime and preventing hardened criminals from continuing gang-related activities from inside jails."

The government plans to implement the Transfer of Prisoners (Punjab Amendment) Act, 2025 in Delhi. Under the amended framework, undertrial prisoners can be transferred between states with the mutual consent of the governments concerned or approval of the Ministry of Home Affairs.

The move seeks to address a gap in the existing legal framework. The Transfer of Prisoners Act, 1950 primarily provides for the transfer of convicted prisoners, while undertrials are governed by separate provisions and cannot currently be transferred from Delhi to prisons in other states under the existing system.

The government said the need for such a mechanism has become more pressing with hardened criminals allegedly continuing to operate their networks from inside prisons. In May 2026, authorities identified 188 members of 26 gangs in

UNDER AMENDED FRAMEWORK, UNDERTRIAL PRISONERS CAN BE TRANSFERRED BETWEEN STATES WITH THE MUTUAL CONSENT OF GOVERNMENTS CONCERNED OR APPROVAL OF MHA...

Delhi, of whom 107 had been arrested.

According to the government, some high-risk undertrials continue to be involved in threats, extortion, gang rivalries and organised criminal conspiracies while in custody.

Their presence in Delhi prisons can also facilitate contact with local criminal networks and contribute to gang conflicts inside jails.

Officials believe shifting such inmates outside Delhi could limit their ability to influence witnesses, interfere with investigations or expand criminal networks.

The Punjab amendment, which received Presidential assent on April 21, 2025, provides for inter-state transfer of undertrials in the interest of security, law and order or public interest.

The Model Prison and Correctional Services Act, 2023 also provides for inter-state transfer of undertrial prisoners, subject to the consent of the trial court.

The Delhi government said the proposed framework will strengthen prison management.

Briefs

14th-floor fall kills two workers

GREATERNOIDA:Two construction workers, Sarkar, 19, and Jamal Sheikh, 45, died after falling from the 14th floor of an under-construction tower at Golf Homes Society in Greater Noida West on Saturday, police said. The contractor was detained and the site supervisor questioned over possible safety lapses. Police are examining conflicting accounts on whether safety harnesses were used and whether a construction lift played a role. The bodies were sent for post-mortem.

Tillu gang aide caught

NEWDELHI:The Delhi Police Crime Branch arrested Arjun alias Parmod, 36, an alleged Tillu Tajpuria gang member, in connection with the July 30 murder of rival Gogi-Dinesh Karala gang member Mathur in Karala. Police said Arjun, who had been absconding, was arrested from Sonipat's Rai on August 22. Two other accused, Rahul Ranga and Sahil alias Vishal, were previously arrested.

Two killed & teen injured in knife attack

GHAZIABAD:A 47-year-old man allegedly killed his wife and teenage daughter and injured his younger daughter during a knife attack at their fourth-floor flat in Khoda on Saturday, police said. Mohammad Raja Ansari was overpowered by neighbours and arrested. His wife Baby Tabassum Ansari, 43, and daughter Sana, 16, died, while Zoya, 14, survived.

Police said Ansari claimed he was depressed and attacked his family after an argument over his medication. He allegedly told police he feared being jailed after his wife's death.

MCD removes 390 tonnes of road dust in SW Zone

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 23

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has intensified sanitation and environmental improvement measures in its South West Zone under the "Delhi Ko Kude Se Aazadi" campaign, with nearly 390 tonnes of dust removed from roads and 29 garbage vulnerable points (GVPs) cleaned thrice daily.

Between August 17 and 22, the zone carried out intensive manual and mechanised cleaning operations across major road stretches, markets and vulnerable waste-accumulation points.

According to the MCD, around 79 km of roads were manually deep-cleaned, resulting in the removal of nearly 190 tonnes of dust. Another 200 tonnes was lifted through mechanical road sweeping machines.

The campaign also focused on preventing waste accumulation at 29 GVPs, which were cleaned three times a day. Night sweeping was undertaken at 25 markets to maintain sanitation in high-footfall commercial areas.

As part of efforts to improve public infrastructure, 22 potholes were repaired during the period. The civic body also undertook plantation activities, adding 212 trees and 73 shrubs to the zone's green cover.

South West Zone DC Shashvat Saurabh said regular road cleaning, mechanised dust removal, GVP cleaning, night sweeping, pothole repairs and plantation would continue to improve cleanliness and environmental conditions across the zone.

DMRC secures ISO cert for Asset Management

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) has become the first metro organisation in India to receive ISO 55001:2024 certification for its Asset Management System, marking a shift towards risk-based and lifecycle-focused management of metro infrastructure.

The certification covers DMRC's asset management system for Mumbai Metro Line-3, where it handles operations and maintenance of the 33.5-km corridor connecting Colaba, Bandra

and SEEPZ.

The latest ISO standard provides a framework for managing assets throughout their lifecycle, balancing performance, operational risks, costs and long-term value.

DMRC said the system was strengthened through an enhanced Strategic Asset Management Plan, improved risk assessment and lifecycle controls, and personnel training.

Its O&M responsibilities cover rolling stock, traction, signalling, telecommunications, stations, lifts, escalators, track and civil infrastructure.

AFFORDABLE & PREMIUM HOUSING PUSH DDA plans 10 housing schemes this year

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, August 23

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) is targeting the launch of 10 housing schemes this year, with an estimated revenue target of Rs 3,500 crore, as it expands its focus across both affordable and premium housing segments. The authority had introduced nine housing schemes last year.

The proposed schemes this year are expected to be offered on a first-come, first-served basis and will cover MIG, LIG and other affordable housing categories.

THE MASTER PLAN 2047 PLACES SIGNIFICANT EMPHASIS ON AFFORDABLE HOUSING AND ENVISAGES 30 LAKH HOUSING UNITS

The DDA is also set to launch a new phase of its premium housing scheme in localities including Dwarka, Rohini and Vasant Kunj, with the flats to be offered through e-auction.

Affordable housing remains a key focus of the DDA's broader housing strategy. Under the provi-

sions of the Master Plan, developers constructing EWS flats will receive an additional 15 per cent FAR. Of the resulting development, 50 per cent will comprise EWS flats, while the remaining 50 per cent will be developed under CSP provisions.

These flats will be sold at affordable rates in accordance with DDA policy.

The Master Plan 2047 places significant emphasis on affordable housing and envisages 30 lakh housing units. Delhi's housing requirement, including that of slum dwellers, is estimated at 40-50 lakh units. The plan also pro-

vides for the rehabilitation of slum dwellers through slum rehabilitation projects and land pooling for affordable housing.

The broader housing strategy includes the redevelopment of existing housing societies and the improvement and regularisation of unauthorised colonies.

Under PM-UDAY, basic infrastructure and amenities such as water supply, drainage and roads are also being addressed.

The overall objective is to move towards the de-slumification of Delhi and contribute to the vision of a Viksit Delhi.

DDA plans 20+ meets on MPD-2047

Outreach to bring MPs, industry, residents, landowners into discussions...

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, August 23

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will hold more than 20 stakeholder meetings over the next three months to facilitate dialogue on key provisions and the implementation of the Master Plan for Delhi-2047 (MPD-2047).

The outreach initiative, being undertaken under the directions of Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, will bring together elected representatives, government agencies, professional bodies, industry representatives, residents, landowners and other stakeholders to discuss the Plan's implementation.

The meetings will focus on major provisions of MPD-2047, including Transit Oriented Development (TOD), High Density Corridors (HDC), Land Pooling and Low Density Areas (LDA).



The exercise will also seek to strengthen coordination and encourage wider participation in translating the Plan's vision into action.

As part of the initiative, the DDA will interact with MPs and MLAs and hold separate meetings with government agencies and service providers. Industries

bodies and chambers, including CII, FICCI, PHD Chamber, ASSOCHAM and DSIIDC, will be engaged on industrial development and land availability for industry.

Architects, planners, professional institutions and private sector stakeholders will participate in discussions on TOD, HDC, Land Pooling and other development opportunities. Interactions with RWAs, Group Housing

CLOSER LOOK

» Architects, planners, professional institutions and private sector stakeholders will participate in discussions on TOD, HDC, Land Pooling and other development opportunities

» Interactions with RWAs, Group Housing Societies and Cooperative Group Housing Societies will focus on the redevelopment of group housing, while area-based meetings with farmers, landowners and local stakeholders will address Land Pooling

Societies and Cooperative Group Housing Societies will focus on the redevelopment of group housing, while area-based meetings with farmers, landowners and local stakeholders will address Land Pooling.

The outreach will also cover Low Density Areas, rejuvenation of the Yamuna and Delhi's blue-green network, heritage conservation, mixed-use development, commercial centres, in-situ slum rede-

velopment, decongestion and improved mobility.

Separate discussions are proposed on developing education and medical hubs in Delhi.

Through the exercise, the DDA aims to raise awareness about the opportunities under MPD-2047 and make its implementation a participatory process involving the government, institutions, industry, communities and citizens.

City plantation drive crosses 50 lakh mark

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

The Delhi government's plantation campaign has gained momentum, with more than 50 lakh saplings planted across the capital against the target of 70 lakh. Health and Transport Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh said on Sunday.

Singh made the remarks while participating in a plantation drive at Shaheed Bhagat Singh Park in Kunwar Singh Nagar, Vikaspuri, along with local residents.

The minister said the plantation campaign was not only about increasing the number of saplings but also ensuring their survival through proper protection, watering and regular care. He stressed that community participation would be crucial to expanding and sustaining Delhi's green cover.

"Planting a tree is only the first step; our real responsibility begins with protecting it and ensuring that it grows into a healthy tree," Singh said, appealing to citizens to participate in plantation drives and take responsibility for nurturing trees.

He said the target of 70 lakh saplings reflected the government's commitment to strengthening Delhi's green cover and urged residents to contribute to the campaign.

Singh also invoked Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign, urging people to plant and nurture trees in the name of their mothers.

The minister praised residents' participation, urging Delhiites to protect trees and make greening a shared responsibility for future generations.

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SYMBIOTEC PHARMALAB LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)



(Please scan this QR Code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and Abridged Prospectus)

Our Company was incorporated as 'Symbiotec Pharmalab Private Limited' as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated September 20, 2002, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh. Subsequently, in the interest of business expansion and issuing fresh shares to the public to meet requirements of funds for a project being undertaken by the Company which would have resulted into increase in the members of the Company beyond fifty, our Company was converted from a private limited company to a public limited company, pursuant to the Board resolution dated September 22, 2005 and a resolution passed in the extraordinary general meeting of our Shareholders held on October 18, 2005 and the name of our Company was changed to Symbiotec Pharmalab Limited, and a certificate of change of name dated October 27, 2005 was issued to our Company by the Registrar of Companies, Madhya Pradesh & Chhattisgarh. Further, considering the absence of public involvement in the shareholding pattern and the management of the Company, our Company was converted to a private limited company pursuant to the Board resolution dated April 23, 2014 and a resolution passed in the extraordinary general meeting of our Shareholders on May 22, 2014 and the name of our Company was changed to Symbiotec Pharmalab Private Limited and a certificate of incorporation, consequent upon conversion to a private limited was issued by the RoC on July 25, 2014. Thereafter, as part of the Company's strategic vision for future growth and expansion, our Company was converted into a public company, pursuant to the Board resolution dated September 11, 2025 and a special resolution dated September 12, 2025 passed in the extraordinary general meeting of our Shareholders. Consequently the name of our Company was changed to Symbiotec Pharmalab Limited and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated September 26, 2025, consequent upon conversion to a public company, was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre. For further details on the changes in the name and registered office of our Company, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 265 of the Red Herring Prospectus dated August 18, 2026 ("RHP") to be read with Addendum to the RHP dated August 19, 2026 ("Addendum").

Corporate Identity Number: U24232MP2002PLC015293; Website: www.symbiotec.com
Registered and Corporate Office: 385/2, Pigdamber, Rau, Mhow, Indore – 453 331, Madhya Pradesh, India | Contact Person: Salil Jain, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; Telephone: +91 731 667 6405; Email: secretarial@symbiotec.com

THE PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY: ANIL SATWANI, KASHISH SATWANI, SUSHIL SATWANI AND SATWANI HOLDINGS LLP

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF OUR COMPANY FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹17,570.00 MILLION ("OFFER"). THE OFFER COMPRISES A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹1,500.00 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY ("FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH ("OFFERED SHARES") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹16,070.00 MILLION, COMPRISING OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹1,440.00 MILLION BY SATWANI HOLDINGS LLP (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER"), UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹9,880.00 MILLION BY ROSEWOOD INVESTMENTS AND UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹4,750.00 MILLION BY INDIA BUSINESS EXCELLENCE FUND – III (THE "INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND TOGETHER WITH THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS" AND SUCH OFFER FOR SALE OF EQUITY SHARES BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFER FOR SALE"). THE OFFER WILL CONSTITUTE [•]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING ₹30.00 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [•]% OF THE POST OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [•]% AND [•]%, RESPECTIVELY, OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY. OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS, MAY OFFER A DISCOUNT OF UP TO [•]% (EQUIVALENT TO ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) TO THE OFFER PRICE TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING UNDER THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT").

THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARE IS ₹2 EACH. THE OFFER PRICE IS [•] TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES. THE PRICE BAND, THE MINIMUM BID LOT AND THE EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT WILL BE DECIDED BY OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS AND WILL BE ADVERTISED IN ALL EDITIONS OF FINANCIAL EXPRESS, A WIDELY CIRCULATED ENGLISH NATIONAL DAILY NEWSPAPER, IN ALL EDITIONS OF JANSATTA, A WIDELY CIRCULATED HINDI NATIONAL DAILY NEWSPAPER AND INDORE EDITION OF INDORE SAMACHAR, A HINDI DAILY NEWSPAPER (HINDI ALSO BEING THE REGIONAL LANGUAGE OF MADHYA PRADESH, WHERE OUR COMPANY'S REGISTERED AND CORPORATE OFFICE IS LOCATED), AT LEAST TWO WORKING DAYS PRIOR TO THE BID / OFFER OPENING DATE AND SHALL BE MADE AVAILABLE TO BSE LIMITED AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED FOR UPLOADING ON THEIR RESPECTIVE WEBSITES IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS AND WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE			
NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS	TYPE	MAXIMUM NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED / AMOUNT (₹ IN MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
Satwani Holdings LLP	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [•] Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹1,440.00 million	49.43
Rosewood Investments	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to [•] Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹9,880.00 million	147.21
India Business Excellence Fund – III	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to [•] Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹4,750.00 million	147.21

*As certified by M/s. A B M S & Associates, Chartered Accountants by way of their certificate dated August 18, 2026.

PRICE BAND: ₹938 TO ₹988 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH.	
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 469.00 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 494.00 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.	
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 15 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 15 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH THEREAFTER.	
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS 10.99%.	
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (P/E) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 OF THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS AS HIGH AS 52.00 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 49.37 TIMES.	
DISCOUNT OF ₹90.00 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.	

The details of the Fresh Issue, Issue Size and the post issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 938 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 988 per Equity Share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	1,602,541		1,521,261	1,500.00
Offer for Sale	17,132,195		16,265,181	16,070.00
Total Issue Size	18,734,736	17,570.00	17,786,442	17,570.00
Post-Issue market capitalization of the Company	64,337,392	60,348.47	64,256,112	63,485.04

BID/OFFER PROGRAMME

BID/OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON: THURSDAY, AUGUST 27, 2026*

*The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid / Offer Closing Date.

We are a research and development-driven, science-based pharmaceutical and biotechnology company with capabilities across three platforms - organic chemistry, biotechnology and complex injectables. Operate as a contract development and manufacturing organisation variably for specialty pharmaceutical and nutraceutical companies globally, offering products and services across the three platforms in which we also manufacture our own products.
The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in accordance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations.
The Equity Shares of our Company will get listed on the main board of BSE and NSE. BSE shall be the Designated Stock Exchange.
QIB Portion: Not more than 50% of the Net Offer Non-Institutional Portion: Not less than 15% of the Net Offer Retail Portion: Not less than 35% of the Net Offer.
EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹30.00 MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRE-OFFER AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMS").

In accordance with the recommendation of committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated August 18, 2026, the above provided price band is justified based on quantitative factors/Key Performance Indicators ("KPI") disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section on page 146 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transaction(s) as applicable, disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" on page 146 of the RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS | For details, refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 28 of the RHP.

1) Revenue dependence on sale of Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients ("APIs"):

We derive almost all of our revenue from the sale of API products, including corticosteroid and steroidal-hormones. In addition to manufacturing API products that we sell, we offer our services as a contract development and manufacturing organisation ("CDMO") for specialty pharmaceutical and nutraceutical companies. Any reduction in demand for API products, and our top products in particular, or a temporary or permanent discontinuation in our manufacturing operations for such products, could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.

Particulars	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)
Sale of APIs (A)	8,350.05	96.07%	7,447.54	99.10%	7,162.47	100.00%
Sale of complex injectables (B)	330.50	3.80%	-	-	-	-
CDMO services (C)	10.94	0.13%	68.00	0.90%	-	-
Total (A+B+C)	8,691.49	100.00%	7,515.54	100.00%	7,162.47	100.00%

- 2) **Audit and inspections risk:** We operate in a highly competitive industry where regulatory standards are not only extensive but also continuously evolving. We are required to comply with regulations and quality standards stipulated by regulatory authorities and certain of our customers. Our manufacturing facilities and products are subject to periodic inspections and audits by these regulatory authorities and customers. If we are not in compliance with the requirements prescribed by such authorities or terms stipulated in contracts with our customers, we may be subject to regulatory actions, including issuance of warning letters, imposition of sanctions, amendment or withdrawal of our existing approvals, product seizure, interruption of our operations, or claims resulting from non-compliance with contractual obligations.
- 3) **Dependence on export markets:** As of March 31, 2026, revenue from external customers outside India contributed 67.04%, 55.19% and 59.97% of our revenue from operations in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Our inability to handle risks associated with our export sales could adversely affect our sales to customers in foreign countries, our results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.

Particulars	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)
Revenue from external customers - India (A)	2,865.05	32.96%	3,367.75	44.81%	2,867.23	40.03%
Revenue from external customers outside India (B)	5,826.44	67.04%	4,147.79	55.19%	4,295.24	59.97%
- Europe	2,529.86	29.11%	2,271.07	30.22%	2,124.20	29.66%
- United States	1,140.00	13.12%	302.02	4.02%	642.60	8.97%
- China	82.90	0.95%	115.58	1.54%	22.19	0.31%
- Rest of the world*	2,073.68	23.86%	1,459.13	19.41%	1,506.25	21.03%
Revenue from operations (A+B)	8,691.49	100.00%	7,515.54	100.00%	7,162.47	100.00%

* Rest of the world includes Asia (other than India and China) and Africa.

- 4) **Tariff and anti-sourcing risk:** Revenue from the United States represented 13.12%, 4.02% and 8.97% of our revenue from operations for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024. The imposition of tariffs or other anti-sourcing measures by the United States could increase our costs, affect the competitiveness of our products and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.
- 5) **Customer concentration risk:** We derive a substantial portion of our revenue from certain key customers, with our top ten customers accounting for 57.59%, 55.90% and 61.65% of our revenue from sale of products in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any loss of, or reduction in orders from, these customers could adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.

Particulars	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from sale of products (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from sale of products (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from sale of products (%)
Top five customers	3,475.98	43.01%	3,037.13	42.27%	3,154.83	48.51%
Top ten customers	4,654.71	57.59%	4,015.76	55.90%	4,009.50	61.65%

- 6) **Geographic concentration risk:** As of March 31, 2026, we operated the Rau Facility and the Pithampur Facility in the state of Madhya Pradesh in India. In addition, our Ujjain Facility and our Mhow Facility, which we have commissioned and where we have started R&D and pilot-scale operations as of March 31, 2026, are also located in Madhya Pradesh. Any adverse developments affecting Madhya Pradesh or its surrounding regions could adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. A slowdown, interruption or shutdown in our manufacturing operations could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.
- 7) **Supplier concentration risk:** We depend on certain suppliers for raw materials for our operations. Purchases from our top ten suppliers accounted for 25.50%, 18.41% and 50.33% of our total expenses in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any loss of such suppliers or non-performance of their obligations could adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.

Particulars	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of total expenses (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of total expenses (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of total expenses (%)
Top five suppliers	1,501.96	21.16%	850.41	13.97%	2,293.90	38.81%
Top ten suppliers	1,810.15	25.50%	1,120.78	18.41%	2,974.31	50.33%

- 8) **Competition risk:** We operate in a highly competitive market. We face competition both within our API manufacturing business and in our role as a CDMO, which we have recently commenced. An inability to compete effectively may adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.
- 9) **Dependence on imported raw materials:** We procure a portion of our raw material requirements from different countries, including China and the United States. Any adverse developments in these countries, or the laws governing our imports from these countries, could disrupt our raw material supply and adversely affect our results of operations, financial condition and cash flows

Particulars	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of total expenses (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of total expenses (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of total expenses (%)
Raw materials sourced domestically	781.35	11.00%	915.79	15.04%	785.62	12.84%
Raw material imports	1,868.82	26.32%	1,197.36	19.67%	3,275.61	55.43%
- United States of America	59.77	0.84%	39.10	0.64%	20.02	0.34%
- China	1,695.24	23.88%	1,024.32	16.82%	3,119.82	52.79%
- Other countries*	113.81	1.60%	133.94	2.20%	135.76	2.30%

*Other countries include countries such as Singapore, Malaysia and Germany.

- 10) **Product development risk:** Our success depends on our ability to develop and commercialise new products in a timely manner. Our research and development ("R&D") efforts are central to our ability to build, scale, and sustain complex manufacturing technologies across platforms. If our research and development efforts do not succeed, or the products we commercialise do not perform as expected, the introduction of new products may be hindered, which could adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. In order to remain competitive, we must develop, test and manufacture new products, which must meet regulatory standards and receive requisite regulatory approvals.

Particulars	Fiscal 2026	Fiscal 2025	Fiscal 2024
Research and development expenses (₹ million) (A)	296.95	311.43	205.09
Total expenses (₹ million) (B)	7,099.02	6,088.49	5,909.85
Research and development expenses, as a percentage of total expenses (%) (A/B*100)	4.18%	5.12%	3.47%

- 11) **Risk related to transfer of shares:** The Investor Selling Shareholders, India Business Excellence Fund – III, together with its co-investors, namely, Mahendra Fulchand Sundesh and Namranyan Nathmal Saraf jointly with Indra Saraf will transfer 203,866 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each for a consideration of ₹200.00 per Equity Share aggregating to ₹40.77 million and Rosewood Investments will transfer 1,508,478 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each for a consideration of ₹200.00 per Equity Share aggregating to ₹301.69 million, immediately prior to the filing of the Red Herring Prospectus, to our Promoter, Satwani Holdings LLP pursuant to the above sharing arrangement as provided for in the Investment Agreement which will be undertaken at a price lower than the Offer Price and will result in an aggregate increase of 2.73% in the pre-offer shareholding (on a fully diluted basis) of Satwani Holdings LLP.
- 12) **The Selling Shareholders will receive the entire proceeds from the Offer for Sale. We will not receive or benefit from any proceeds from the Offer for Sale portion.**
- 13) **The weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share acquired by our Promoters (which includes the Promoter Selling Shareholder) and Selling Shareholders, as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows:**

S. No.	Name of Promoter	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each held as on date	WACA per Equity Share (in ₹)
Promoters			
1.	Anil Satwani	2,810,896	276.00
2.	Kashish Satwani	2,750,896	273.04
3.	Sushil Satwani	1,233,938	72.37
4.	Satwani Holdings LLP	11,277,374	49.43
Selling Shareholders			
1.	Rosewood Investments	19,042,092	147.21
2.	India Business Excellence Fund - III	11,386,687	147.21

As certified by M/s. A B M S & Associates, Chartered Accountants by way of their certificate dated August 19, 2026.

*Also participating as the Promoter Selling Shareholder.

- 14) **Weighted Average Return on Net worth for past three Fiscals i.e. 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 10.99%**
- 15) **Weighted average cost of acquisition of all equity shares transacted in the one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus**

Period	Weighted average cost of acquisition per equity share (in ₹)*	Cap Price is 'x' times the weighted average cost of acquisition	Range of acquisition price per equity share: lowest price – highest price (in ₹)**
Last one year preceding the date of this Red Herring Prospectus	440.00	2.25	0-988
Last 18 months preceding the date of this Red Herring Prospectus	432.98	2.28	0-988
Last three years preceding the date of this Red Herring Prospectus	432.98	2.28	0-988

*As certified by M/s. A B M S & Associates, Chartered Accountants by way of their certificate dated August 19, 2026.

**Adjusted for sub-division of equity shares.

- 16) **The details of the Price/Earnings (P/E), Earnings per Share (EPS), Return on Net Worth (RoNW) and Net Asset Value (NAV) per Equity Share for our Company and peer group for the year ended 2026 appear hereunder:**

Name of the company	Face value (₹ per equity share)	Closing price on August 17, 2026 (₹)	Revenue from operations for Fiscal 2026 (in ₹ million)	EPS (₹) for Fiscal 2026	NAV (₹ per equity share) for Fiscal 2026	P/E ratio as on August 17, 2026	RoNW for Fiscal 2026 (%)
Symbiotec Pharmalab Limited	2	988.00*	8,691.49	19.10	19.00	184.69	52.00*
Listed Peers							
Concord Biotech Limited	1	1,513.40	10,549.00	24.78	24.78	NA	61.07
Divi's Laboratories Limited	2	8,495.00	105,600.00	96.75	96.75	631.00	87.80
Cohance Lifesciences Limited	1	444.70	22,685.50	4.69	4.68	NA	95.02
Laurus Labs Limited	2	1,799.00	68,129.00	16.47	16.45	NA	109.36

As certified by M/s. A B M S & Associates, Chartered Accountants, pursuant to certificate dated August 19, 2026.

*Determined based on the Cap Price

For further details and relevant footnotes, please refer to page 150 of the RHP.

- 17) **The BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 83 public issues in the past three years, out of which 26 issues closed below the offer price on listing date.**

Name of BRLMs	Total Issues	Issues closed below IPO price on listing date
JM Financial Limited*	30	11
Avendus Capital Private Limited*	4	1
Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited**	25	8
Nomura Financial Advisory and Securities (India) Private Limited*	8	2
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	16	4
Total	83	26

**In compliance with the proviso to regulation 21A(1) and explanation (iii) to regulation 21A(1) of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations, and regulation 23(3) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited will be involved only in marketing the Offer. Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited has signed the due diligence certificate and has been disclosed as a BRLM for the Offer.

*Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken Pre-IPO Placement.
2. The details of Secondary Transfer made on August 17, 2026 are set forth below:

S. No.	Date of transfer	Name of Transferor	Name of Transferee	Number of equity shares transferred	Percentage of pre-Offer share capital of our Company	Face value per equity share (₹)	Transfer price per equity share (₹)	Nature of consideration	Total consideration (₹ in million)
1.	August 17, 2026	Anil Satwani	Motilal Oswal India Excellence	340,000	0.54	2	988.00	Cash	335.92
2.	August 17, 2026	Satwani Holdings LLP	Fund – Mid to Mega Series III	165,000	0.26	2	988.00	Cash	163.02
Total				505,000	0.80				498.94
3.	August 17, 2026	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Satwani Holdings LLP	197,244	0.31	2	200.00	Cash	39.45
4.	August 17, 2026	Rosewood Investments		1,508,478	2.40	2	200.00	Cash	301.69
5.	August 17, 2026	Mahendra Fulchand Sundesha		4,282	0.01	2	200.00	Cash	0.86
6.	August 17, 2026	Namarayan Nathmal Saraf jointly with Indra Saraf		2,340	Negligible	2	200.00	Cash	0.47
Total				1,712,344	2.73				342.47

3. Our Investor Selling Shareholders, Rosewood Investments and India Business Excellence Fund – III have, pursuant to separate share purchase agreements each dated August 19, 2026, entered with the transferees set out in the table below, transferred an aggregate of 6,557,619 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each, representing 10.43% of the pre-Offer paid up Equity Share capital of our Company, on a fully-diluted basis (“Sale Shares”) at a price of ₹988.00 per Equity Share, as follows:

S. No.	Nature of Transaction	Name of Transferor	Name of the Transferee	Date of Transfer	Whether transferee is connected, in any manner, with the Company, the Promoters, members of the Promoter Group (including the Promoter Selling Shareholders), the Directors, the Key Managerial Personnel, the Subsidiaries, and group companies and their respective directors and key managerial personnel*	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each transferred	Percentage of pre-Offer share capital of the Company on a fully diluted basis, after the transfer of Sale Shares (%)	Transfer Price per Sale Share (₹)	Total consideration (in ₹ million)
1.	Secondary Sale	Rosewood Investments	Think India Opportunities Master Fund LP	August 19, 2026	No	1,771,255	2.82	988.00	1,750.00
2.	Secondary Sale	Rosewood Investments	Dymon Asia Multi-Strategy Investment (Singapore) Pte. Limited	August 19, 2026	No	1,012,145	1.61	988.00	1,000.00
Sub-total (A)						2,783,400	4.43	-	2,750.00
1.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	ValueQuest Founders Conviction LVF	August 19, 2026	No	1,771,255	2.82	988.00	1,750.00
2.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	VQ Fastecap Fund II	August 19, 2026	No	253,035	0.40	988.00	250.00
3.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	WhiteOak Capital India Opportunities Fund	August 19, 2026	No	506,071	0.81	988.00	500.00
4.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	WhiteOak Capital Equity Fund	August 19, 2026	No	50,607	0.08	988.00	50.00
5.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	WhiteOak Capital Healthcare Opportunities Fund	August 19, 2026	No	50,607	0.08	988.00	50.00
6.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Singularity Equity Fund I	August 19, 2026	No	454,395	0.72	988.00	448.94
7.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Waterfield Flagship Fund II	August 19, 2026	No	151,820	0.24	988.00	150.00
8.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Eterna Prima - Scheme II	August 19, 2026	No	101,215	0.16	988.00	100.00
9.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	1729 Growth Fund I	August 19, 2026	No	101,215	0.16	988.00	100.00
10.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Jaya Chandrakant Gogri	August 19, 2026	No	101,215	0.16	988.00	100.00
11.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Anshul Goel	August 19, 2026	No	50,605	0.08	988.00	50.00
12.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Piyush Jalan Family Trust	August 19, 2026	No	50,605	0.08	988.00	50.00
13.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Arvind Kapur	August 19, 2026	No	50,605	0.08	988.00	50.00
14.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Landmark Capital Markets Private Limited	August 19, 2026	No	50,605	0.08	988.00	50.00
15.	Secondary Sale	India Business Excellence Fund – III	Aluka Kavitha	August 19, 2026	No	30,364	0.05	988.00	30.00
Sub-total (B)						3,774,219	6.00	-	3,728.93
Total (A+B)						6,557,619	10.43	-	6,478.93

*For the purpose of this confirmation, (i) ‘connected with’ is deemed to mean that (a) there are no common directorships or common key managerial personnel between the Subject Persons and the investment manager of the transferees; and/or (b) there is no more than 1% equity investment interest by the transferees and investment manager of the transferees in the Subject Persons and also of the Subject Persons in the investment manager of the Purchasers and (ii) ‘Subject Persons’ shall mean, collectively, the Company and its Promoters and members of the Promoter Group (including the Seller), Directors, Key Managerial Personnel and Subsidiaries of the Company and their respective directors and key managerial personnel.

4. Investors should read this advertisement along with the RHP and the abridged prospectus, filed with the ROC and submitted to SEBI and Stock Exchanges, the pre-Offer and Price Band advertisement each dated August 18, 2026 and addendum to the RHP dated August 19, 2026 before making an investment decision with respect to the Offer.

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE



You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of JM Financial Limited

The “Basis for Offer Price” section on page 146 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the website of the BRLMs: www.jmfl.com, www.avendus.com, www.motilaloswal.com and www.nomuraholdings.com/company/group/asia/india/index.html for the “Basis for Offer Price” updated with the above price band.

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid / Offer Period (except the Bid / Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. IST
Bid / Offer Closing Date	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIBs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹0.50 million)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹0.50 million)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification / Revision / Cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and NIBs*	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid / Offer Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST on Bid / Offer Closing Date

*UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 pm on Bid / Offer Closing Date.

*QIBs and NIBs can neither revise their Bids downwards nor cancel / withdraw their Bids.

Bid/Offer Programme	
ANCHOR INVESTOR BID/OFFER PERIOD OPENS AND CLOSES ON	Friday, August 21, 2026 ⁽¹⁾
BID/OFFER OPENS ON	Monday, August 24, 2026 ⁽²⁾
BID/OFFER CLOSES ON	Thursday, August 27, 2026 ⁽³⁾

ASBA# Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) is a better way of applying to Issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.



UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CDBT Notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CDBT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹0.50 million in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section “Offer Procedure” on page 451 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (“AIBI”) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited has been appointed as the Sponsor Bank for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI ICDR Master Circular. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll-free number: 18001201740 and mail id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid / Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid / Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid / Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid / Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid / Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to Self-Certified Syndicate Banks (“SCSBs”), Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable.

This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contract (Regulation) Rules, 1957 (“SCRR”) read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers (“QIBs”), and such portion, the “QIB Portion”, provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis (“Anchor Investor Portion”). 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for the domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds on or above the price at which allocation will be made to Anchor Investors (“Anchor Investor Allocation Price”) in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any under-subscription in the reserved category specified in clause (i) above may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (other than the Anchor Investor Portion) (“Net QIB Portion”). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to QIB Bidders (other than Anchor Investors) including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders (out of which one-third of the portion available to Non-Institutional Bidders shall be reserved for Bidders with an application size of more than ₹20.00 million and up to ₹1.00 million and two-thirds shall be reserved for Bidders with an application size of more than ₹1.00 million, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of the aforementioned sub-categories may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category) and not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees applying under the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders, other than Anchor Investors, are required to participate in the Offer by mandatorily utilising the Application Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) process by providing details of their respective ASBA Account (as defined hereinafter) and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders (as defined hereinafter), as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or by the Sponsor Banks under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA process. For further details, see “Offer Procedure” on page 451 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN, UPI ID and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are

advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants’ sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes notification dated February 13, 2020 and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021, March 30, 2022 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, investors are requested to see “History and Certain Corporate Matters” on page 265 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” on page 538 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.
Amount of Share Capital of our Company and Capital Structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorized share capital of our Company is ₹300,000,000 comprising of 150,000,000 Equity Shares of face value ₹2 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of our Company is ₹125,469,702 comprising 62,734,851 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each. For details of the capital structure of our Company, see “Capital Structure” on page 106 of the RHP.

Names of the Initial Signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company along with their allotment are: Anil Satwani, Manohar Satwani and Kashish Satwani were the initial subscribers to the MOA. For details of the share capital history and capital structure of our Company see “Capital Structure” on page 106 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received ‘in-principle’ approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to letters each dated February 4, 2026. For the purposes of the Offer, BSE Limited is the Designated Stock Exchange. A copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been filed with the RoC and a copy of the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus until the Bid / Offer Closing Date, see “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” on page 538 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”): SEBI only gives its observations on the Draft Red Herring Prospectus and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 424 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of the SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of the NSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Draft Red Herring Prospectus has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to page 427 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of the BSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Draft Red Herring Prospectus has been cleared or approved by the BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to page 427 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to “Risk Factors” on page 28 of the Red Herring Prospectus.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS				REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
				 MUFG Intime	Salil Jain , 385/2, Pigdamber, Rau, Mhow, Indore – 453 331, Madhya Pradesh, India; Email: secretarial@symbiotec.com
JM Financial Limited 7 th Floor, Cnergy Appasaheb Marathe Marg Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030 E-mail: symbiotec.ip@jmfl.com Investor Grievance email: grievance.lbd@jmfl.com Website: www.jmfl.com Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361	Avendus Capital Private Limited Platina Building, 9 th Floor, 901, Plot No C-59, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6648 0050 Email: symbiotec.ip@avendus.com Investor grievance email: investorgrievance@avendus.com Website: www.avendus.com Contact person: Sarthak Sawa / Ananya Chawla SEBI Registration No.: INM000011021	Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited^{^A} Motilal Oswal Tower, Rahimtullah Sayani Road, Opposite Parel ST Depot, Prabhadevi, Mumbai – 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 7193 4380 E-mail: sgl.ipo@motilaloswal.com Investor Grievance E-mail: moiaip@motilaloswal.com Website: www.motilaloswal.com Contact Person: Kunal Thakkar/Vaibhav Shah SEBI Registration No.: INM000011005	Nomura Financial Advisory and Securities (India) Private Limited Ceejay House, Level 11, Plot F, Shiv Sagar Estate, Dr. Annie Besant Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 018, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4037 4037 E-mail: symbiotecipo@nomura.com Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievances-in@nomura.com Website: www.nomuraholdings.com/company/group/asia/india/index.html Contact Person: Vishal Kanjani / Chirag Shah SEBI Registration No.: INM000011419	MUFG Intime India Private Limited <i>(Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited)</i> C-101, Embassy 247, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400 083, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 810 811 4949 Email: symbiotecpharmalab.ipo@in.mpmf.com Investor grievance email: symbiotecpharmalab.ipo@in.mpmf.com Website: www.in.mpmf.com Contact person: Shanti Gopalakrishnan SEBI Registration No.: INR000004058	Bidders may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any Pre-Offer or Post-Offer related problems, such as non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

^{^A}In compliance with the proviso to regulation 21A(1) and explanation (iii) to regulation 21A(1) of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations, and regulation 23(3) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited will be involved only in marketing the Offer. Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited has signed the due diligence certificate and has been disclosed as a BRLM for the Offer.

*In compliance with the proviso to regulation 21A(1) and explanation (iii) to regulation 21A(1) of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations, and regulation 23(3) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited will be involved only in marketing the Offer. Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited has signed the due diligence certificate and has been disclosed as a BRLM for the Offer.

AVAILABILITY OF RHP: Investors should note that investment in Equity Shares involves a high degree of risk and investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the Risk Factors contained herein, before applying in the Offer. Full copy of the RHP shall be available at the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, the website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, the website of our Company at www.symbiotec.com and the website of BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com, Avendus Capital Private Limited at www.avendus.com, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com and Nomura Financial Advisory and Securities (India) Private Limited at www.nomuraholdings.com/company/group/asia/india/index.html respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of our Company at www.symbiotec.com, the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com, Avendus Capital Private Limited at www.avendus.com, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com, and Nomura Financial Advisory and Securities (India) Private Limited at www.nomuraholdings.com/company/group/asia/india/index.html respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Application forms can be obtained from the Registered Office of our Company Symbiotec Pharmalab Limited, Tel: +91 731 667 6405 and the BRLM – JM Financial Limited, Tel: +91 22 6630 3030, Avendus Capital Private Limited, Tel: +91 22 6648 0050, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited, Tel: +91 22 7193 4380 and Nomura Financial Advisory and Securities (India) Private Limited, Tel: +91 22 4037 4037.

SYNDICATE MEMBER: JM Financial Services Limited, Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, Spark Institutional Equities

Symbiotec Pharmalab Limited is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to undertake an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with the Registrar of Companies, Madhya Pradesh at Gwalior, SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on August 18, 2026. The RHP is to be read with Addendum to the RHP dated August 19, 2026 (“Addendum”) which is available on the websites of the Company i.e. www.symbiotec.com and SEBI, BSE and NSE at www.sebi.gov.in, www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, and on the website of the Book Running Lead Managers i.e. JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com, Avendus Capital Private Limited at www.avendus.com, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com and Nomura Financial Advisory and Securities (India) Private Limited at www.nomuraholdings.com/company/group/asia/india/index.html. Potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see the section titled “Risk Factors” on page 28 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI for making any investment decision but should only rely on the information included in RHP filed by the Company with the RoC for making investment decisions.

This announcement does not constitute an invitation or offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction.

The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been, and will not be, registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (“U.S. Securities Act”) or any other applicable law of the United States, and unless so registered may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold outside of the United States in “offshore transactions” as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales are made.

Swarna Morcha protesters held in Lucknow over UGC rules

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, August 23

More than 300 members of the Swarna Morcha, largely from the Brahmin and Thakur communities, staged a protest in Lucknow on Sunday against the new University Grants Commission (UGC) regulations, demanding that reservation be implemented solely on economic grounds.

The protesters assembled around noon at the Women Power Line crossing and raised slogans demanding the rollback of the UGC regulations. Many carried placards carrying the words “Constitutional Untouchables” and demanded that the government withdraw the new rules completely.

DOVAL & WANG SCHEDULED TO HOLD SR TALKS

Doval to visit China for boundary talks ahead of Xi’s India trip

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 23



NSA Ajit Doval

National Security Advisor Ajit Doval is scheduled to arrive in Beijing on Monday to take part in the India-China Special Representatives (SR) talks on the boundary issue with his Chinese counterpart Wang Yi.

Doval and Wang are scheduled to hold the 25th round of SR talks on Tuesday, according to official sources.

Both Doval and Wang are the designated SRs for the boundary talks mechanism, which was established in 2003 to comprehensively address the vexed boundary dispute of the India-China border spanning 3,488 km.

While success eluded it

in resolving the boundary dispute, officials on both sides regard the structured mechanism as a useful tool in addressing the recurring tensions between the two countries on various fronts.

The upcoming talks assume significance as they are being held ahead of the much-anticipated visit of Chinese President Xi Jinping to India to attend the BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12-13.

While there is no official confirmation about Xi’s visit, officials on both sides are optimistic about the Chinese leader’s participation, which could provide an opportunity for a meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on the sidelines of the summit to discuss initiatives to take forward bilateral ties.

The two leaders met in August last year on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Tianjin.

Ahead of Doval-Wang talks in Beijing, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Saturday reiterated that peace and tranquillity along the border areas are prerequisite for good relations with

China.

His comments came amid reports of aggressive posturing by Chinese troops in Arunachal Pradesh’s Upper Subansiri region in recent weeks. “I think we went through a particularly bad patch between the summer of 2020 and the autumn of 2024, and that was primarily an outcome of the situation in the border areas,” Jaishankar said at the Economic Times World Leaders Forum in New Delhi on Saturday.

“At the end of the day, peace and tranquillity in the border areas is a prerequisite for good relations, and the state of the border, to a very large measure, naturally would determine the state of the relations,” he said.

Journalist moves SC against FIR in road rage case

Upadhyay flagged alleged irregularities in the handling of donations at Ayodhya’s Ram temple

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

A plea has been filed in the Supreme Court by a journalist, who flagged alleged irregularities in the handling of donations at Ayodhya’s Ram temple, challenging an FIR lodged against him by Ghaziabad police in an alleged road rage case.

The plea by journalist Abhishek Upadhyay claimed that the FIR is based on concocted allegations against him and is an attempt to harass him for his independent journalistic works.

In the plea, he has contended that the FIR copy has not been supplied to him and that the police were forcing nearby shop-

keepers to delete the CCTV visuals of the relevant time.

Upadhyay sought quashing of the FIR, or in the alternative, its investigation be transferred to an independent agency other than the Uttar Pradesh Police.

“The Petitioner apprehends imminent arrest and further physical harm and states that, in view of the aforesaid sequence, he is not in a position to safely approach the High Court of Judicature at Allahabad.

“He apprehends that he may be arrested or subjected to physical harm by planted goons of the state machinery in the State of Uttar Pradesh before he can obtain effective judicial protection,” the plea said.

“He is there-

fore seeking quashing of the impugned FIR and in alternative ready and willing to join the investigation and cooperate with the Investigating Agency in accordance with law with a request that present FIR as well as other FIRs filed against him because of his reporting on Ramjanmabhumi donation theft issue may please be directed to be investigated by Delhi police or Central Bureau of Investigation,” his plea said.

The FIR has been lodged against Upadhyay in Ghaziabad over an alleged road rage incident, which he has claimed was planted in connection with his reporting on alleged corruption in Uttar Pradesh.

From page 1

Monsoon Session

been prorogued. Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh asked whether Union Home Minister Amit Shah was still trying to secure what he described as a “super-tainted” two-thirds majority for a delimitation-linked constitutional amendment in a special session.

Ramesh said the interval between the sine die adjournment and prorogation of the Lok Sabha is generally two to four days, while in several cases both have occurred on the same day.

“Ten days have gone by since this Lok Sabha was adjourned sine die but still there is no information on its prorogation,” he said.

He acknowledged that longer gaps had occurred in the past, citing the Monsoon session of 2015, when the gap was 28 days, and that of 2021, when it was 20 days. However, he said there were no “diabolical” moves underway on those occasions.

Questions over the government’s plans have persisted following Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay’s remarks at the Southern Zonal Council meeting in Mahabalipuram on August 21. The meeting was chaired by Shah.

Vijay called for a clear legislative assurance that no state would lose its share of parliamentary representation because of its success in controlling population growth.

“I urge the Union government to provide a clear legislative assurance that no state will suffer a reduction in its percentage of representation in Parliament on account of its success in population stabilisation,” he said.

His position marked a shift from the categorical opposition to delimitation reflected in a resolution he moved in the Tamil Nadu Assembly on August 12.

Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar, who attended the Mahabalipuram meeting, took a different position, calling for the existing strength of 543 Lok Sabha seats to be retained for the next 25 years. The contrasting demands from southern states have kept the question of delimitation and the women’s reservation legislation at the centre of the political debate even as Parliament’s Monsoon session remains formally open.

you, we can attract the entire talent pool like a magnet, and that can become a massive strength for us,” he said.

The prime minister also credited private space entrepreneurs for taking risks in a new sector and trusting the government’s reforms. He said policy consistency was important for encouraging businesses to take risks.

“Whatever decision we make, we must remain consistent and avoid making frequent changes,” Modi said, adding that such stability gives entrepreneurs confidence that they would not be abandoned if they faced difficulties.

Modi said India was highly competitive on cost and had no shortage of talent. “Because of these, we can establish our place very rapidly,” he said.

During the interaction, the CEOs cited the progress of Skyroot Aerospace, India’s first space-tech unicorn, which successfully launched the country’s first private rocket into orbit. They said the company was targeting one launch every month by mid-2027. Factories had already been established with capacity for one rocket a month, with a longer-term goal of one launch a week and eventually several launches a day.

The founders said investor confidence had risen significantly after Skyroot’s first launch. Another startup said it secured eight launch contracts in the previous month following a single launch, most of them international. The startups also said their goal for the next 18 months was to establish a global ground station network.

Modi asked the entrepreneurs to explore applications of space technology in agriculture, livestock management, dairy, the environment and other areas affecting daily life. He assured young space entrepreneurs of full government support and called for greater cooperation between space companies and other sectors.

The 20 startups at the interaction were Skyroot Aerospace, Agnikul Cosmos, Pixxel, Dhruva Space, GalaxEye, PierSight, Belatrix Aerospace, Digantara, SatSure, Suhora Technologies, Manastu Space, Astrobase, TakeMe2Space, VyomIC, Cosmoserve Space, OrbitAID Aerospace, SkyServe (Hyspace), Serendipity Space, Vassar Labs and mistEO.

On National Space Day, Modi said, “Happy National Space Day”, and shared a video on India’s space achievements. The day marks Chandrayaan-3’s safe and soft landing of the Vikram Lander on the Moon on August 23, 2023.

Modi

“We should create an aura where people worldwide feel that if they want to make a career, they should go to India,” Modi said, responding to a startup founder who said many Indians working in the US and Europe were considering returning after the sector was opened to private companies.

Modi said India should attract people from across the world to its startups and space agencies. “I firmly believe that because of

on Thursday alone. The Delhi government has advised people to maintain respiratory hygiene, avoid crowded places and seek medical advice without delay when required.

Union Health Minister J P Nadda reviewed the HINI situation and preparedness across the country on Friday, with particular attention to Delhi. Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh also attended the meeting.

Nadda reviewed national surveillance and epidemiological trends, influenza-like illness (ILI) and severe acute respiratory infection (SARI) patterns, testing and laboratory surveillance. He also assessed health-care preparedness, including hospital beds, critical care and oxygen-supported beds, ventilators, essential medicines, diagnostics and other supplies.

The ICMR sources said the situation is being monitored through regular surveillance. They advised people to consult a doctor if symptoms persist, worsen or become severe. Nadda also called for close monitoring and early detection and management of any unusual increase or clustering of cases.

Maintenance of ministers’

electrical systems, plumbing problems and other repairs. In the past, there have also been plans, though never officially announced, to raze and rebuild some of the bungalows.

“These are mostly 80-90-100-year-old bungalows. Some, though not all, had even become structurally unsafe and needed to be upgraded,” an official said.

Built as part of the development of New Delhi as the imperial capital, the bungalow zone was developed between 1912 and 1930 and later adapted for use by senior government functionaries after Independence. Besides ministers, the bungalows are also occupied by members of Parliament, senior judges and top military officers among others.

Historian and author Swapna Liddle told PTI that Edwin Lutyens lent his name to the Lutyens Bungalow Zone but himself designed only the official bungalows located within the President’s Estate, which surrounds the erstwhile Viceroy’s House, now Rashtrapati Bhavan.

“Most of New Delhi’s colonial-era government bungalows were designed by architects of the Public Works Department under the British administration,” said Liddle, author of “Connaught Place and the Making of New Delhi”.

“These bungalows reflected the same pattern seen in residences that the British built in Civil Lines in most Indian cities to house their officials: a big compound, with ancillary buildings for the staff apart from the main building. One such bungalow, currently occupied by Home Minister Amit Shah on Krishna Menon Marg, once

housed Herbert Baker, the architect of the old Parliament Building and the North and South Blocks,” she added.

From 2014 to 2019, the ministers spent an average of Rs 26.78 crore per year on repairs and upgradation. The average annual spending doubled to nearly Rs 50 crore from 2019 to 2024. In 2024-25, the spend was Rs 71.98 crore and last year it was Rs 92.35 crore, according to the RTI reply.

While the information was sought, the CPWD did not furnish data on expenditure incurred during this period on the residences of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha MPs who are not ministers, or on the offices of Union ministers and ministers of state.

The Union council of ministers over the years has comprised around 70 to 72 Cabinet ministers and ministers of state. At Rs 92.35 crore in the last financial year, the cost of repairs and renovation works out to an average of Rs 1.2 crore per minister, though actual expenditure varies from residence to residence.

The year-wise expenditure stood at Rs 27.47 crore in 2014-15, Rs 29.57 crore in 2015-16, Rs 30.10 crore in 2016-17, Rs 23.34 crore in 2017-18, Rs 23.42 crore in 2018-19, Rs 26.37 crore in 2019-20, Rs 53.87 crore in 2020-21, Rs 40.84 crore in 2021-22, Rs 73.86 crore in 2022-23, Rs 54.52 crore in 2023-24, Rs 71.98 crore in 2024-25 and Rs 92.35 crore in 2025-26, shows the RTI response.

A staff member of a Cabinet minister told PTI on condition of anonymity that the most frequent demands for repair and renovation mostly concern electrical items such as fans, LED lights and plumbing work every few months, and replacing floor tiles every few years.

According to an RTI response in September 2009, between 2004 and 2009, a period of five years, the government spent a cumulative Rs 93.50 crore on maintenance and renovation of bungalows allotted to Members of Parliament and Union ministers.

she was abused, assaulted and threatened. It also said Khanam was around three months pregnant and had told her family by phone about the alleged harassment.

Police said Azam told investigators that the couple had an argument shortly before the incident. His statement, recorded in the FIR, said Khanam locked him in one room before going to another. He alerted the landlord, who helped him out, after which Khanam was found hanging.

“Appropriate action will be taken based on evidence and facts emerging during the investigation,” an officer said. Further investigation is underway.

Navdeep Suri

he described how a routine visit to submit his documents turned into a struggle to establish his eligibility.

“Sharing my experience with SIR in Punjab. Went to BLO, submitted Voter ID and Aadhaar card, was assured that everything is in order. Got a message today from a volunteer saying some details don’t match with SIR in 2003!” Suri wrote on X.

Suri, the former Indian envoy with service spanning between 1983 to 2019, said that after being told his documents do not match, he was asked to return with documents proving he is an Indian citizen. This was after he had already submitted his voter ID card and Aadhaar card.

Detailing his ordeal on X, Suri said that since he was not in India in 2003, he was asked to submit his passport as proof.

He highlighted that he had to face the hassle despite a long diplomatic career and said, “If I have trouble establishing my citizenship after representing India in three countries, what’s the fate of the common citizen?”

The Election Commission of India, the state government or the Centre has not yet issued any official statements on this matter.

The Draft Electoral Roll, 2026, for all 117 assembly constituencies in Punjab was published last week under SIR 2026, in accordance with the programme announced by the Election Commission of India, chief electoral officer Anindita Mitra said.

The publication marks the beginning of the second phase of the exercise, during which claims and objections can be filed from August 13 to September 12, 2026, followed by the notice phase and disposal of claims and objections till October 8, 2026. The final electoral rolls will be published on October 12.

Earlier, as part of the ongoing SIR of electoral rolls in Punjab, enumeration forms of nearly 1.94 crore electors, out of the total electorate of 2.14 crore, were collected and digitised during the enumeration exercise.

22 missing sailors

nationals within hours. They were being brought ashore aboard MV Aisopos and were receiving medical care.

The Andaman and Nicobar Command said aerial surveillance detected two floating life rafts and an oil slick near the reported location of the vessel. Coast Guard ships Varad, Anmol and Vijit are involved in the search.

Ocean Winner sailed from Paradip on August 20 for China carrying about 72,000 tonnes of iron ore. Its crew comprised 20 Chinese, three Myanmar and one Bangladeshi nationals. The ship had a cargo capacity of about 73,000 tonnes.

Shipping Minister Sarbananda Sonowal said agencies were coordinating the search and rescue operation.

Nijjar killing

A leaked audio conversation between Brar and UK-based Khalistani terrorist Param-

jit Singh Pamma has surfaced nearly three years after Nijjar was shot dead outside a gurdwara in Canada on June 19, 2023. Brar, who is wanted in India in several murder cases, including that of Punjabi singer Sidhu Moosewala, is heard explaining his alleged motive for the killing.

Brar claimed Nijjar supported and strengthened a drug network for his own use. He alleged that people linked to the network recruited 16 and 17-year-old children, forcing them into drug sales and using blackmail to make them work as informers.

“Those who would prepare 16-17-year-old children to sell drugs... those who would blackmail children into selling drugs and acting as informers... Nijjar supported such people and made them stronger so that he could use them when required,” Brar is heard saying.

He also alleged that Nijjar was involved in the illegal weapons trade. “Because of this, we had to kill him. Everyone has to bear the consequences of what they have done,” Brar said in the recording.

Brar rejected any suggestion that he was involved in the drug trade, saying, “I have never dealt with chitta (drugs) and will never do so.”

Nijjar’s killing led to a serious diplomatic dispute between India and Canada after then-Prime Minister Justin Trudeau alleged a potential link between Indian agents and the murder. India rejected the allegation as “absurd” and “motivated”. The dispute led to diplomatic expulsions and a suspension of several bilateral engagements.

Relations improved after Trudeau left office and Mark Carney became prime minister, with India and Canada resuming diplomatic engagement.

Canadian police have since said they found “no evidence” implicating Indian government officials in the case.

Brar’s claims in the leaked recording represent his account and do not independently establish the motive or circumstances surrounding Nijjar’s killing.

Former Odisha minister Pritiranjan Gharai sought an independent inquiry into the shipment and sinking, including the quantity, value, ownership and destination of the mineral cargo.

The incident recalls two earlier cases near Paradip in 2009 involving MV Black Rose and MV Vinalines Mighty, both carrying iron ore.

India may own space

real-time monitoring and tracking among the areas where space technology is being used. He also said satellite-based systems were helping with the safety and security of citizens.

Narayanan said the Gaganyaan human spaceflight programme and the Bharatiya Antariksha Station were among the major projects currently being pursued by India.

“Under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, many programmes are in the pipeline. We are working on the Gaganyaan programme. We are also working towards establishing our own space station, the Bharatiya Antariksha Station,” he said.

“The first module has already been approved, and we aim to establish the space station by 2035,” he added.

Union Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, who also spoke at the event, recalled the significance of Chandrayaan-3, which landed on the Moon on August 23, 2023, near the lunar south polar region. The landing site was named Shiv Shakti Point. “Following the success of the Chandrayaan mission and the announcement by the Prime Minister, India will observe the day it set foot on the Moon’s south pole at the ‘Shiv Shakti Point’ as National Space Day,” Shekhawat said.

The third National Space Day was being observed in Ahmedabad under the aegis of the Space Applications Centre. Shekhawat also pointed to the growing role of private companies in the space sector, saying the opening of the sector had created new opportunities for the country.

“ISRO’s workload has not decreased; rather, its operational capacity has expanded manifold,” he said.

According to Shekhawat, the time required for several space-related activities, including developing applications, manufacturing satellites and payloads, and launching satellites, had also been reduced. These processes were now being carried out with greater proficiency, he said.

The celebrations come as India moves from its early focus on basic satellite and launch capabilities towards lunar exploration, human spaceflight, advanced Earth observation and wider use of space-based services. With Gaganyaan and the proposed space station, the country is preparing for sustained human activity in space beyond lunar missions.

EDITORIAL

Tariff Boomerang

The latest rupture in US-Canada trade relations shows why tariffs rarely remain confined to the country they are intended to punish. After eleventh-hour negotiations collapsed, President Donald Trump's 50 per cent duties on about \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods took effect, covering products from cement and agricultural produce to clothing, furniture and hockey sticks. Canada has promised dollar-for-dollar retaliation from September 8, pushing two deeply integrated economies further into a trade war. The immediate exposure may represent only about 5 per cent of Canada's annual exports to the United States, but that understates the wider consequences. American importers pay these tariffs, leaving businesses to absorb the expense or pass it on to customers. Construction companies, retailers, manufacturers and farmers could consequently face higher costs when households remain acutely sensitive to prices. Protectionism may sound attractive when presented as making another country pay, but its political appeal diminishes when consumers discover that part of the bill has landed on them.

More troubling is Washington's decision to invoke Section 338 of the Tariff Act of 1930, a Depression-era provision allowing duties of up to 50 per cent against countries judged to discriminate against American commerce. The broader Smoot-Hawley tariff regime became synonymous with the protectionist spiral that worsened the collapse in global trade during the Great Depression. Retaliation still has a dangerous tendency to acquire momentum. Canada plans countermeasures covering steel, dairy, appliances, agricultural equipment, pulp, paper and electronics, exposing American exporters to pressures Washington is imposing on Canadian producers. Also concerning is that some goods previously protected under the US-Mexico-Canada Agreement. Trade agreements matter because they provide businesses with predictability. If their protections can be overridden whenever political negotiations fail, companies will reconsider investment decisions, suppliers and production networks built around those rules. The damage then extends beyond individual tariffs to confidence in North American commerce.

Trump's strategy also carries growing domestic political risks. Tariffs have already complicated planning and contributed to inflationary pressures, while the conflict with Iran has introduced another source of price instability. Adding steep duties on goods from America's closest trading partner could compound those pressures in a midterm election year dominated by concerns over affordability. Canada, meanwhile, has learned that concessions do not necessarily guarantee lasting relief, making Ottawa less willing to accommodate demands. The United States has every right to challenge unfair trade practices, just as Canada must accept reciprocal obligations. But durable economic relationships require negotiation, enforceable rules and proportionate remedies, not a contest to erect higher barriers. Tariffs can create leverage, but repeated use against allies encourages alternative supply chains, weakens trust and imposes uncertainty on businesses. Washington may hope economic pressure will force Ottawa back to the table on American terms. It must also reckon with the possibility that the casualties will ultimately be American companies, workers and households paying more for goods that once crossed their border with comparatively little friction.

LETTER



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22-Year Wait

East Bengal's emphatic 4-1 derby victory over Mohun Bagan was a fitting end to their 22-year wait for the Durand Cup. Edmund Lalrindika's remarkable hat-trick made the triumph unforgettable. With both Kolkata giants now level on 17 titles, Indian football's greatest rivalry has acquired another glorious chapter.

ARJUN MAJUMDAR,
SILIGURI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Falling Market Premium

Indian investors are pouring money into mutual funds even as returns weaken, while global financiers are turning cautious. Is India losing its growth sparkle?

TALKING SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER IS A JOURNALIST & COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST

"Price is what you pay. Value is what you get."
— Warren Buffett

For years, India has been the market investors have wanted to own. For years, the story seemed almost irresistible. The world's fastest-growing major economy, a booming consumer juggernaut, rising incomes, expanding infrastructure, a digital revolution and the promise of becoming the next great manufacturing hub. But investment stories, like markets, are never permanent; they have to keep earning their premium.

Two recent developments offer a reason to pause. The first is India's mutual fund industry, where the number of schemes posting negative annual returns in FY 2025-26 nearly tripled to 731 from 243 a year earlier. At the other end, schemes delivering more than 10 per cent returns fell from 304 to 198. The second comes from abroad. A Bank of America survey of 98 fund managers over-seeing \$272 billion says India has become Asia's 'least-preferred' stock market, with 32 per cent of respondents underweight. Indo-



India's financialization is running ahead of its returns

nesia, previously at the bottom of the preference table, has moved ahead of India.

By itself, neither development is cause for panic. Together, they raise a question worth asking: Is the India investment story beginning to encounter resistance?

Domestic Bet

The curious thing is that Indian investors do not appear to have lost faith. A pointer is the mutual fund assets under management, which rose 12.2 per cent to Rs 73.7 lakh crore by March 2026. The number of unique investors climbed by 13.2 per cent to 6.1 crore, while SIP accounts rose to 10.45 crore. Average monthly net SIP contributions jumped 25.8 per cent to Rs 16,413 crore.

That is an extraordinary vote of confidence from Indian households. Yet, a different picture is extremely uncomfortable. Schemes netting between 0 and -5 per cent rose to 492 from 172. Those losing between 5 and 10 per cent rose to 146 from 41, while schemes losing 10 per cent or more rose to 93 from 30. The lesson is not that MFs are suddenly bad. Markets rise and fall, and one year

INDIA IS STILL A POWERFUL INVESTMENT DESTINATION, BUT THE PREMIUM THAT INVESTORS ONCE READILY PAID FOR INDIA SEEMS TO BE WANING

of returns proves little about long-term wealth creation.

The disquieting lesson is that India's financialization is running ahead of its returns. Lakhs of new investors are entering the markets, presumably because they believe in India's long-term economic prospects. They may soon discover that believing in the economy and earning strong market returns are not always the same thing.

Foreign Warning

The foreign-investor signal is

disconcerting. Bank of America found that the leading concern about India is its lack of clear exposure to the artificial intelligence investment boom, followed by weak growth, high valuations and a perceived lack of reforms. That does not mean the world has suddenly written India off. More than US \$4 billion has flowed into Indian equities this quarter. Nor should foreign fund managers be treated as oracles. They can (and often do) get markets spectacularly wrong.

But sentiment matters because capital is competitive. For years, India benefited from being seen as the obvious long-term destination for global investors seeking growth. Today, investors have more choices. Indonesia is one. Other emerging markets are competing for the same capital. And the question being asked is no longer whether India will grow, but how much growth is already priced into Indian assets. That is a very different question.

Growth Test

This is where the two stories meet. India is attracting enormous investment into electronics, renewable energy, semiconduc-

tors, infrastructure, digital services and manufacturing. Its infrastructure is improving rapidly. But markets ultimately demand more than investment announcements; they want productivity, earnings, innovation and scalable businesses that justify the valuations investors are asked to pay.

The AI question is the most revealing. India has built one of the world's most impressive digital ecosystems, but global capital is increasingly chasing the companies and countries positioned to capture the next wave of AI-driven investment. India cannot assume that its existing technology credentials automatically translate into leadership in the next technology cycle. Nor can high valuations remain indefinitely insulated from weaker-than-expected growth or earnings. This is not a case for pessimism. It is a case for urgency.

Pay Tomorrow

India remains among the world's most consequential economies. Its domestic market is enormous, its financial system is deepening and its infrastructure build-out is creating opportunities that would have seemed improbable a decade ago. But perhaps the most dangerous thing India can do right now is confuse a strong economic narrative with a guaranteed investment outcome. The domestic investor is still betting on India. The foreign investor is becoming selective. And the market is sending both messages at once.

The right response is neither complacency nor alarm. It is to make the underlying economy stronger: faster productivity growth, deeper reforms, more innovation, stronger companies, better earnings and a credible place in the technologies shaping the next investment cycle. India does not need to persuade the world that its story is not over. It needs to demonstrate that the next chapter will be worth paying for. After all, markets do not punish ambition. They punish complacency.

Views expressed are personal

New Strains in Old Ties

The Hasina row seems to have strained Delhi-Dhaka ties as Tarique is likely to skip BRICS summit

DIPLOMATIC CROSSROADS



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IPS OFFICER, ADVISER NATSTRAT

According to Prothom Alo, a leading Bangla newspaper published from Dhaka, fresh tensions have emerged in Bangladesh-India relations after ousted Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina was given an opportunity to speak directly to journalists in Delhi. Possibly against this backdrop, it has become almost certain that Prime Minister Tarique Rahman will not attend the outreach session of the BRICS summit, scheduled in Delhi (September 12-13). The newspaper authenticates its input, quoting several high-level sources in the Bangladesh government, that, following the recent developments, the possibility of the Prime Minister attending the BRICS outreach session has effectively evaporated.

It may also be recalled that Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi had invited Tarique Rah-

man, in his capacity as the current chair of BIMSTEC, to attend the session. The invitation was conveyed in a diplomatic letter sent to Bangladesh's Ministry of Foreign Affairs through the Indian High Commission in Dhaka as early as July 14. Here, the first courtesy call by India's newly appointed High Commissioner to Bangladesh, Dinesh Trivedi, on Prime Minister Tarique Rahman in Dhaka is being viewed as significant. Later, Trivedi called on the Indian Prime Minister on August 11, apprising him of his meeting with the Bangladesh Prime Minister and taking guidance for the further course of action.

In view of the prevailing strain in Indo-BD ties, it is pertinent to put things in perspective. Former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's virtual press conference, carried at the Foreign Correspondents' Club of South Asia (FCC) in New Delhi on August 5, has not augured very well with the Bangladesh government, which has categorically stated that this development is likely to dent the existing Indo-BD bilateral relations. While the Government of India has officially denied any involvement in this press conference, calling the entity (FCC) a private organisation, the Bangladesh media has sharply reacted to the press conference, questioning the credibility of an entity comprising such a huge number of journalists where a fugitive political leader of another country appeared without the knowledge or clearance of the government. They have also blamed the Indian media, which had advertised the said conference well in advance, confirming that it was a pre-planned move.



Political turmoil threatens the rebuilding of bilateral trust

NORMALISING INDO-BANGLADESH TIES IS DIFFICULT, BUT CERTAINLY NOT BEYOND DIPLOMATIC REACH

The Bangladesh press and a large segment of people are also critical of the press conference for Hasina having made political statements. The media in Dhaka generally reckon that Sheikh Hasina's press conference proves two things. She is not retiring from politics anytime soon, and she intends to retain the leadership of her party. The reality is that the anger and outrage against her 16-year rule, which led to her ouster, are still prevalent in the country. How-

ever defiant she may sound when she declares that she will return to the country to challenge her conviction, she will also have to accept the ire of the public. Her statement at the press conference that she will return to Bangladesh sounds like empty rhetoric, given that her own party is unable to rally around her now, as per the Dhaka Tribune — a widely read English daily.

Daily Star, another prominent daily, on the other hand, observed that the August 5 event assumed additional significance because India's new High Commissioner to Bangladesh, Dinesh Trivedi, had, during a courtesy call on Prime Minister's Foreign Affairs Adviser Humayun Kabir on August 3, received an unusually strong and advance warning against allowing the deposed Awami League Chief Hasina any platform to make political statements. The paper further states that Dhaka's response

to the decision to allow Hasina to speak remotely at the FCC-hosted event was both expected and justified, although some Bangladesh watchers argue that an even stronger protest could have been lodged through a more carefully calibrated choice of words. India's Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the event was a private media interaction, that the Indian government had no role in it, and that it did not endorse what was said there. He also added that the Indian government "does not endorse anything said at the forum, especially with regard to the duly constituted government of Bangladesh."

Dhaka, meanwhile, has viewed positively the above remarks made by the Indian Foreign Ministry spokesperson at the ministry's regular briefing on August 8. Responding to a question, Jaiswal also said that the Indian government did not endorse anything said at the forum, especially with regard to the duly constituted Government of Bangladesh. According to members of Bangladesh's diplomatic community, India's position indicates that, despite the recent tensions, neither country is interested in allowing relations to deteriorate further. There is still an opportunity to take the relationship forward on the basis of mutual respect, dignity, shared interests and sensitivity towards each other's concerns. Although it is a huge challenge to normalise Indo-BD ties, it is not impossible due to the wisdom of the political leadership on both sides, as well as committed diplomats working hard to do their best.

Views expressed are personal

SCHOOLS CLOSED IN TWO DISTRICTS

Monsoon mayhem: Heavy rainfall lashes Odisha; flash floods in Hati

MPOST BUREAU
Bhubaneswar, August 23

Flash floods were reported in the embankments of the Hati River in Odisha's Kalahandi district on Sunday amid low pressure-triggered heavy rainfall across the state that also prompted the administrations of two other districts to announce school holidays the next day, officials said.

Under the impact of the low-pressure area in north-western Bay of Bengal, heavy rainfall is expected in several districts of Odisha till August 26, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said.

Authorities released 412 cusecs of water from the Mangalpur Barrage of the Indravati Project into Hati River, which was already in spate, causing flash floods in its embankments this morning, officials said.

Floodwaters entered low-lying areas of Talpada, Bankapala and Jampadar villages under Kalampur block. The block administration, led by BDO Vijay Kumar Marandi, rescued 293 people from both Paruaguda and Bodelbandh villages and provided them with free ration, an official said. Road communication from Junagarh to Kalampur and Thuamul Rampur Road to Kashipur has been disrupted due to heavy rain.

In view of the rainfall



People wade through a flooded area following heavy rainfall and the rising water level, in Kendrapara on Sunday

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Heavy rainfall is expected in several districts of Odisha till August 26, the IMD said
- » Floodwaters entered low-lying villages under Kalampur block
- » Several areas in the state received heavy to extreme heavy downpour

forecast, district administrations have announced that all schools and anganwadi centres in Nabarangpur, and 89 schools in vulnerable areas of Bhadrak would remain closed on Monday.

Several areas in the state received heavy to extreme heavy downpour in the last 24 hours till 8.30 this morning. Of those, at least two places recorded

over 200 mm of rainfall.

Thuamula Rampur in Kalahandi district recorded extreme heavy rainfall of 345 mm, while Kashipur in Rayagada district received 212 mm of downpour, the weather office said.

Nineteen other places recorded between 100 mm and 200 mm of rainfall in the last 24 hours, it said.

The upper air cyclonic circulation over the Bay of

Bengal off the West Bengal-Bangladesh coasts intensified into a low-pressure area during early Sunday morning, the IMD said.

The system is likely to move northwards across north Odisha adjoining Gangetic West Bengal in the next 24 hours, it said.

The weather office also issued an 'orange' warning (be prepared to take action) for Sundergarh, Jharsuguda, Bargarh, Sambalpur, Sonepur, and Boudh districts for Monday.

Similarly, a 'yellow warning' (be aware) has been issued for Balasore, Deogarh, Anugul, Keonjhar, Mayurbhanj, Nua-pada, Bolangir, Kalahandi, Kandhamal, Nawarangpur, Rayagada, Koraput, Malkangiri, Gajapati, Ganjam,

and Nayagada.

Thunderstorms, accompanied by lightning and gusty surface wind, are expected in many other places across Odisha, the IMD said.

Squally weather, with wind speed of 40-60 kmph, was likely to prevail over the Bay of Bengal and along and off the West Bengal coast and adjoining Odisha till Monday.

The IMD advised fishermen not to venture into the sea along the Odisha coast till August 24 as conditions would be rough.

Meanwhile, Health Minister Mukesh Mahaling, accompanied by Director of Public Health, Rabindranath Mishra, visited Bhadrak on Sunday and reviewed the flood situation.

As part of the emergency response, 16 medical relief centres have been opened in the worst-affected areas of Dhamnagar, Bhandaripokhari, Chandabali and Tihidi blocks of the coastal district, officials said.

Besides, eight rapid response teams (RRTs) and 10 mobile health units have been deployed in the affected areas of Bhadrak, with health workers conducting continuous house-to-house surveillance, they said.

Nearly 3 lakh people in 244 villages across five blocks of the district have been affected by the floods.

Guj hooch tragedy: toll rises to 13

MPOST BUREAU
Bhavnagar, August 23

The death toll due to the consumption of spurious liquor in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district went up to 13 on Sunday after two more victims succumbed during treatment, officials said.

Three other persons were still in hospital, they said. In the last two days, five persons have lost their lives. Mukesh Damor (36) and Bhargav Upadhyay (42) are the latest victims of the hooch tragedy. With their death, the number of victims has gone up to 13, the officials said.

Upadhyay was undergoing treatment at a private hospital, while Damor was admitted to the civil hospital.

According to officials, 67 persons had consumed the liquor containing methanol, a highly toxic substance.

Gujarat is a 'dry' state where the manufacture, sale and consumption of alcohol is banned. According to police, the victims consumed spurious liquor packed in bottles bearing the name of a popular Indian-made foreign liquor (IMFL) brand.

The authorities traced 24 other persons who had consumed the liquor for their medical examination. All of them were found to be in normal health, an official said. The death toll currently stands at 13, he said. Police have so far arrested 13 of the 21 accused named in the FIR registered.

SC to hear plea for CBI probe into JPSC prelims row today

Plea seeks transfer of investigation from state CID to Central agency

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 23

The Supreme Court is scheduled to hear on Monday a plea seeking an independent, time-bound probe by the CBI into alleged malpractices in the Jharkhand Combined Civil Services Preliminary Examination.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joyrnalya Bagchi and V Mohana is likely to take up the petition filed by activist Harisharan Devgan, through advocate Satyam Singh Rajput, for hearing. "The present writ petition under Article 32 of the Constitution of India is being preferred in public interest seeking urgent intervention of this court in relation to serious and substantial concerns regarding the integrity, fairness, transparency and credibility of the Jharkhand Combined Civil Services Preliminary Competitive Examination-2025, conducted by respondent no. 2-Jharkhand Public Service Commission pursuant to Advertisement No. 01/2026 on April 19, 2026," it said.

The plea has also sought transfer of the investigation from the state CID to the CBI to ensure an impartial probe into public officials and examination agencies.

"The petitioner submits that the controversy



IT HAS ALSO SOUGHT DIRECTION TO IMMEDIATELY SECURE ALL PHYSICAL AND DIGITAL EVIDENCE

cannot appropriately be examined merely as a dispute concerning individual candidates or isolated instances of alleged malpractice.

"The allegations require examination of the entire examination chain, including preparation and printing of question papers, coding, storage, transportation, distribution, conduct of the examination, collection and custody of OMR sheets, scanning, coding and decoding, evaluation, storage and access to electronic examination data, generation of the result and publication thereof," it said.

It has also sought direction to immediately secure all physical and digital evidence, including original and candidate-held OMR carbon copies, CCTV footage, and server audit logs, to prevent tampering.

SAF Conclave to focus on 'net-zero' goal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

The Centre's push to develop a sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) ecosystem will receive an industry boost at the second SAF Conclave in New Delhi on September 28, which will focus on scaling up production capacities and achieving the aviation sector's net-zero carbon emission target by 2050.

The two-day conclave, organised under the aegis of the SAF Association, is expected to bring together more than 1,000 delegates, over 100 speakers and stakeholders from more than 25 countries.

Airlines and airport authorities, energy companies, technology developers, investors and financial institutions are expected to participate in discussions on investment opportunities, technology partnerships, project linkages and market access for clean-energy aviation technologies. The agenda will include ministerial meetings, technical conferences, capacity-building sessions, investor and buyer forums, leadership roundtables, B2B and B2G meetings, technology showcases, exhibitions and MoU signings.

"The conclave's theme - 'India's SAF opportunity: accelerating investment, innovation, and collaboration to realise net-zero vision' - reflects India's potential to emerge as a global SAF destination and the need for an ecosystem of government, industry, technology, finance, and international partners," said Rohit Kumar, Secretary General, SAF Association and CMAI. He said India could benefit significantly from projected global demand for 40 million tonnes of SAF by 2050.

Briefs

MP Hooda expresses regret

CHANDIGARH: Congress MP Deepender Singh Hooda on Sunday expressed regret over remarks that he said were distorted and clarified that he had not used the term "role model". He said he never intended to hurt Sikh sentiments and highlighted his family's four-generation bond with the community. Hooda said he had always advocated justice for the 1984 riots' victims.

CISF bags 5 Taekwondo medals

NEW DELHI: The CISF Taekwondo contingent won five medals, including two gold, a silver and two bronze, at the 5th Indian Taekwondo Kyorugi National Championship 2026-27 in Pune. Kanishka and Saina Khan clinched gold, while Riya won silver. Ritik and Pankaj secured bronze medals.

NFR adds record solar capacity

MALIGAON: North-east Frontier Railway commissioned 23.7 MWp of solar power capacity between January and July 2026, the highest among Indian Railways' zonal units. With this addition, NFR's total installed solar capacity reached 42.1 MWp by July 2026.

Anti-narcotics drives set to begin from Sept

New Delhi, August 23

Anti-drugs trafficking agencies will launch a year-long national enforcement drive from September to apprehend absconding narcotics offenders, inspect medical shops for diversion of pharmaceutical drugs and prisons as part of an action plan to dismantle syndicates dealing in drugs trafficking.

The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) has recently written to all the states and various central agencies tasked to fight drug crimes asking them to undertake 24 different special drives that will run for a fortnight each till August next year, officials said.

While an awareness program for students in schools and colleges is ongoing since August 16, the enforcement action drives will begin from September which includes a fortnight where foreigners who indulge in drug crimes will be identified across the country for deportation while the next 15-day drive

THE NATIONWIDE DRIVES WILL RUN FOR A FORTNIGHT EACH TILL AUGUST NEXT YEAR, OFFICIALS SAID

will target absconding narcotics offenders, according to the action plan.

Beginning October, the NCB along with the state and Union Territories Anti-Narcotics Task Forces (ANTFs) will inspect medical stores and pharmacies in coordination with jurisdictional drug controllers to check diversion of pharma drugs for narcotics trafficking.

The action plan, according to the officials, will subsequently suggest separate fortnights for preparation of dossiers against drug crime fugitives, creating awareness among coastal communities on maritime drug trade and coordinated checks at all land, sea and airports in the second-half of December.

Social harmony not a one-day event: Saini

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 23

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday said social harmony was not a one-day event but a way of life that must be practised throughout life, stressing that it should strengthen unity while respecting every identity.

Addressing a Samrasta Sammelan and Pratibha Samman Samaroh organised by the Meghwal Utthan Samiti in Bawal, Rewari, Saini said the government was committed to ensuring that development benefits reached those at the last rung of society.

He honoured 411 young achievers from the Meghwal community.

Saini highlighted the contributions of Guru Ravidas, Mahatma Jyotiba Phule, Mata Savitribai Wale and Dr BR Ambedkar towards equality, education and social transformation.

He said the government was providing free competitive examination coaching to Scheduled Caste stu-



Haryana CM honours 411 young achievers

Nangal Chaudhary hub to connect Haryana with global markets: CM

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 23

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday said the inauguration of rail connectivity to the Integrated Multi-Modal Logistics Hub in Nangal Chaudhary marked the beginning of a new economic momentum for the state.

Interacting with industrialists and investors after

the inauguration, Saini said Haryana would move beyond being merely a producer of goods to becoming a major hub connecting its products with domestic and global markets.

He said the project, whose foundation was laid by former Chief Minister Manohar Lal Khattar, would contribute to the Prime Minister's vision of a Viksit Bharat by 2047.

Offering 'theft' row deepens Ram Temple Trust-panel strain

Temple's Construction Committee chairman Nripendra Misra skips two Trust meetings

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Ayodhya, August 23

KEY POINTS

- » No Trust representative attended the Construction Committee's meetings in July or its three-day meeting held from August 19 to 21
- » The issue assumes significance as Misra had publicly reacted strongly to the offering theft case



The reported theft of offerings at the Ram temple appears to have widened differences between the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust and the Ram Mandir Construction Committee, with the growing distance now becoming visible in their formal meetings.

The development follows the June 6 revelation of the alleged offering theft. Since then, Construction Committee chairman Nripendra Misra has been absent from two consecutive Trust meetings, while

no Trust representative attended the Construction Committee's meetings in July or its three-day meeting held from August 19 to 21. Earlier, former Trust general secretary Champat Rai, trustee Anil Mishra and construction in-charge Gopal Rao regularly participated in Construction Committee meetings. How-

ever, after Rai and Anil Mishra left their respective positions, the Trust has not been represented in the committee's meetings.

The issue assumes significance as Misra had publicly reacted strongly to the offering theft case. From June 18, he appeared in several television interviews in Delhi and described

meeting on July 6, while no Trust office-bearer attended a subsequent Construction Committee meeting in July or the August 19-21 meeting.

Sources associated with the Trust said Misra had been distancing himself from temple management matters for nearly six months and had increasingly focused on construction-related issues. They said earlier meetings involved discussions on both construction and management, with efforts to reach consensus despite differences.

According to the sources, Misra later began

viewing temple management issues as falling within the Trust's jurisdiction and gradually withdrew from such discussions.

Speculation over differences intensified after a letter surfaced recently. Misra dismissed it as fabricated, saying he had never seen the document and alleging attempts to create distrust. He also said the temple construction was funded by the Trust and did not involve government funds.

Attempts to contact Misra and Trust interim general secretary Krishna Mohan for comments were unsuccessful.

Briefs

‘Nishant will become Bihar CM’

PATNA: Senior JD(U) leader Devesh Chandra Thakur on Sunday voiced hope that Bihar Health Minister Nishant would “follow in the footsteps of his father”, Nitish Kumar, the party’s president, and rise to become the state’s chief minister. Thakur was replying to queries from journalists in Sitamarhi, his Lok Sabha constituency, where the state health minister was on a tour, and received a rousing welcome from JD(U) workers across the district.

3 complaints filed against BJP MLA

DIBRUGARH: Three police complaints have been filed against BJP MLA Mayur Borghain for allegedly threatening Rajiour Dal president Akhil Gogoi with physical assault, officials said on Sunday.

The complaints were filed at Sivasagar Sadar police station by people associated with Gogoi and his party, they said.

ED arrests ex-Andhra minister

HYDERABAD: The Enforcement Directorate on Sunday arrested former Andhra Pradesh minister Karumuri Nageswara Rao in a money laundering case linked to alleged irregularities in transport of liquor during the previous YSRCP government, officials said.

Rao was taken into custody under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), they said.

Kailash Mansarovar Yatra ends

GANGTOK: The Kailash Mansarovar Yatra through Sikkim’s Nathu La route concluded on Sunday, with 464 pilgrims completing the pilgrimage in 10 batches, officials said.

The yatra, which began on June 20, concluded with the return of the final batch of pilgrims to Gangtok. The pilgrims visited Mount Kailash and Lake Manasarovar in the Tibet Autonomous Region of China.

Manipur CM talks with Assam Rifles

IMPHAL: Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh on Sunday evening held a discussion with Assam Rifles officials regarding counter-insurgency operations and border management.

Singh, in a social media post, said he held the meeting with Inspector General of Assam Rifles (East), Major General Inderjit Singh Bhinder, and DIG, 22 Sector Assam Rifles, Brigadier Anshuman Tripathi, at the Chief Minister’s Secretariat.

‘CRUCIAL MEET TO DISCUSS RANGE OF MATTERS’

Nabin holds strategy meet for next round of state polls

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

BJP president Nitin Nabin on Sunday held an intensive meeting with the party office bearers to discuss a range of organisational matters, especially the strategy for high-stakes Assembly polls due next year in seven states, including Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat, sources said.

The crucial meeting was attended by the newly-appointed office bearers of the party, presidents of its state units, in-charges of the BJP state units and other senior functionaries at the BJP headquarters here, according to sources.

BJP national general secretary (organisation) BL Santhosh was also present at the meeting, which delved into measures for strengthening grassroots outreach and youth connect, especially in the states where elections are due next year, the sources said.

“Today, at the BJP headquarters, I participated in the meeting held with the newly appointed national office-bearers, state presidents, and state organisation general secretaries, and engaged in detailed discussions on various organisational matters,” Nabin said in a post on X after the meeting.

Assembly polls are due in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa, Himachal Pradesh and Gujarat in 2027. The BJP is in power



BJP president Nitin Nabin and others during a meeting with newly appointed office-bearers and national functionaries of the party, in New Delhi

CLOSER LOOK

- » The crucial meeting was attended by the newly-appointed office bearers of the party, presidents of its state units, in-charges of the BJP state units
- » Assembly polls are due in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa, Himachal Pradesh and Gujarat in 2027. The BJP is in power in five of these poll-bound states, except Punjab and Himachal Pradesh

in five of these poll-bound states, except Punjab and Himachal Pradesh. While the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) currently rules Punjab, the Congress is in power in Himachal Pradesh.

“It’s a crucial meeting to discuss a range of organisational matters with prime focus on the party’s preparations and strategy for the upcoming elections in

states next year,” a source told news agency.

This comes a day after Nabin held his first meeting with all newly appointed national office bearers of the party. Former office bearers of the BJP’s national team were also present.

In another meeting presided over by the BJP chief on Saturday, party state unit presidents and organ-

ising secretaries were also present.

After the day-long meeting concluded on Saturday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi also visited the BJP headquarters and interacted with all 67 newly-appointed national office bearers of the party. The prime minister’s meeting lasted for more than five hours.

“Organisational meetings are all about new ideas and perspectives aimed at strengthening the Party and deepening connect with the people. Great interaction with fellow party colleagues and the new organisational team,” Modi said in a post, sharing pictures from his meeting with the party leaders.

Shah to attend National Security Strategies Conference

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

Union Home minister Amit Shah will attend deliberations on contemporary matters and challenges to national security during the two-day National Security Strategies Conference starting from Monday, officials said.

They said more than 850 officers from various security forces and police from across the country will participate in the conference to be held in a hybrid format.

The ninth National Security Strategy Conference will be held in a hybrid format, combining physical and virtual modes, they said. The officers will deliberate on various contemporary matters and challenges to national security during the conference, the officials said.

DELAY IN PROROGUING MONSOON SESSION OF PARL

Cong: Is HM still in search of ‘super-tainted’ 2/3rd majority

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

Questioning the delay in proroguing the Monsoon session of Parliament, the Congress on Sunday asked whether Union Home minister Amit Shah was still in search of his “super-tainted” two-thirds majority to get the delimitation-linked Constitutional amendment bill passed in a special session.

The Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha were adjourned sine die on August 13.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said the time gap between the adjournment of the Lok Sabha sine die and its prorogation (formal end) is generally two to four days, although there are many instances when adjournment and prorogation have taken place on the very same day.

Ten days have gone by since this Lok Sabha was adjourned sine die but still there is no information on its prorogation, Ramesh pointed out.



Union Home minister Amit Shah

“It is true that the gap for the Monsoon session in 2015 was 28 days and in 2021 it was 20 days. But there were no diabolical moves afoot then,” the Congress leader said on X.

“What explains the abnormal delay now? Is the Union Home minister still in search of his super-tainted 2/3rd majority to get

the Constitutional Amendment Bill on Delimitation passed in a Special Session?” Ramesh said.

“Termination of a session of the House by an order made by the President under Article 85(2) is called prorogation. The President, in exercising the power to prorogue the House, acts on the advice of the Prime Minister. The Prime Minister may consult the Cabinet before the advice is submitted to the President.

programmes.

Test papers for some subjects, which, according to some unconfirmed reports, were created using AI, failed to meet even basic intelligence levels, riddled with multiple grammatical, factual and spelling errors.

Again, the exams were cancelled and rescheduled for next month, putting students into the same rigmarole all over again.

When the NTA was envisaged in November 2017 as a single agency for conducting all higher education entrance exams in the country, it was supposed to be an elixir for all the ills plaguing the exam system for

decades. The govt had then said it would benefit nearly 40 lakh students aspiring to be doctors, engineers, scholars, etc., by bringing in “high reliability” into the exam system.

Less than a decade later, the NTA is being seen as the biggest villain in this space.

From medical and engineering entrance tests to university admissions, the NTA has become a central part of India’s exam system, but questions over its capacity, security mechanisms and centralised structure have thrown its capability to shoulder the responsibility it was entrusted with under the scanner.



Abhijeet Dipke

supporters and volunteers to remain prepared for the outcome of its Monday meeting. The announcements came days after the Supreme Court on August 18 sought a consolidated list of FIRs registered against students and protesters across the country.

The CJP said the top court asked the Centre thrice to provide the list so that it could consider exercising its powers under Article 142 to quash the cases.

“Despite the court repeatedly asking for this list, the Union government did not commit to providing it,” the CJP said.

The outfit said that

immediately after the court hearing, its co-convener Saurav Das and legal affairs lead Ratna Singh raised concern that the government appeared to be “cheating” the younger generation after the CJP called off its agitation on the basis of the commitments made during its talks with the Centre.

The assurances included withdrawal or quashing of all FIRs arising from the protests, a guarantee that no student or peaceful protester would face punitive action in future and compensation for the families of NEET-UG candidates who committed suicide after the test was cancelled in May due to paper leaks.

The CJP also said the government delegation that engaged in parleys with the outfit did not formally reach out to it to place on record the steps being taken to fulfil the written assurances, including on FIRs and compensation.

UP: Fish feast draws Sant community’s ire

hurting Sanatan sentiments and demanded a public apology.

A video purportedly showing the fish feast has surfaced on social media. Claims are also being made that more than two quintals of fish were arranged for the programme. The Congress has not confirmed these claims.

Sants said political activities were welcome in Ayodhya, but parties should not disregard the religious traditions and sentiments

associated with the temple town. They demanded that the Congress leadership explain the circumstances surrounding the event and that Rai apologise to the Sanatan community.

Mahant Bharat Das said the Congress appeared to lack an understanding of Ayodhya’s religious traditions.

“Organising a non-vegetarian feast on a sacred occasion like Sawan and Ekadashi reflects an anti-Sanatan mindset,” he said.

Remarks on Sajjan Kumar, Deepender Hooda expresses regret

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Chandigarh, Aug 23

Facing flak for allegedly calling Sajjan Kumar a role model and describing his death as an “irreparable loss”, Rohtak Congress MP Deepender Hooda on Sunday claimed he never used the words “role model”, but expressed regret if his comments hurt anyone’s feelings.

Controversial former Congress MP Sajjan Kumar, who was serving two life sentences in connection with the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, died at the age of 80 on Thursday.

Condoling Kumar’s demise, Hooda termed it a “loss to the country’s political landscape”, and praised the former Congress MP’s “connect with people and contribution to Delhi’s development”.

The remarks didn’t go down well within his own party, with senior Haryana Congress leader Kuldeep Sharma writing to party president Mallikarjun Kharge seeking Hooda’s removal from the Congress Working Committee (CWC) for his comments “extolling the virtues” of Sajjan Kumar.

The Rohtak MP’s remarks also drew sharp reactions in Punjab, where the SAD, BJP and AAP hit out at the Congress for its “anti-Sikh mindset”.

Asked by reporters in Gurugram if he had called Kumar a role model, Hooda said on Sunday, “I did not use the words, nor did I harbour any such sentiment.”

He added, “These words are being put in my mouth by those who wish to play politics by undermining the spirit of brotherhood. I had no intention of hurting anyone’s feelings; those who know me are aware that I never harboured any intent to cause hurt to anyone.”

THE NATIONAL TESTING AGENCY

From elixir for all exam ills to everyone’s punching bag!

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 23

Ridhima Bansal came out of her NEET-UG centre on a sweltering May afternoon glowing with joy, confident of having cracked her medical entrance examination after months of gruelling preparation.

Days later, she was told that the exam had been cancelled due to paper leaks and she would have to go through the grind again for a retest.

Ridhima was not alone. More than 20 lakh students appeared for NEET-UG 2026, and many of them were as confident as her.

KEY POINTS

- » NTA which conducted the NEET-UG exam, came under severe attack for obvious reasons. So did the government
- » The issue was still hot when the NTA ran into a fresh controversy – this time for the UGC-NET for PhD and other scholar programmes



under severe attack for obvious reasons. So did the government.

Widespread protests were held across the country, spearheaded by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), led stir at the Jantar Mantar, which eventually led to the resignation of the education

Some of them could not bear the mental trauma and took their lives; many others could not study as hard again and failed to make the cut for medical admissions.

The National Testing Agency (NTA), which conducted the exam, came

minister, an amendment to a law to check malpractices in public exams, and a high-powered task force to clean up the system.

The issue was still hot when the NTA ran into a fresh controversy – this time for the UGC-NET for PhD and other scholar

News at a glance

Indonesia: 72 people held for starting forest fires

JAKARTA: Indonesian police on Sunday arrested 72 people suspected of starting some of the recent forest and peatland fires as huge blazes in central and western parts of the country triggered a harmful cloud known as a choking haze.

Indonesia has been battling fires driven by an intensifying El Nino pattern and a prolonged dry season, generating dense smoke that crossed into Malaysia, as per Indonesia's National Disaster Management Agency. Fires are a regular problem in the country and often strain relations with neighbours.

China postpones ambitious Chang'e-7 mission launch

HAIKOU: China said on Sunday it was postponing its planned ambitious Chang'e-7 lunar mission, which was set to carry out explorations including searching for water ice on the moon. The Chang'e-7 spacecraft was originally set to lift off in the coming days from the Wenchang Space Launch Site on China's southern Hainan island.

The mission does not meet the launch conditions, said the China Manned Space Agency in a brief statement, and "cannot take place during the planned window this year."

Kazakhstan holds parliamentary election

TALLINN: Kazakhstan was voting Sunday in a parliamentary election that is expected to further strengthen President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev's grip on power in Central Asia's largest nation.

The pro-presidential Adilet party is widely predicted to win an overwhelming majority, with several smaller parties loyal to Tokayev also anticipated to enter parliament. The vote is the country's first election to a new, single-chamber parliament called the Kurultai. The 73-year-old Tokayev has been in office since 2019.



A man being silhouetted against the haze from wildfires that blankets Musi River in Palembang on Sunday

AP/PTI

Briefs

Pak Deputy PM to visit the UK

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan's Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar will undertake a five-day official visit to the United Kingdom on Monday where he will hold meetings with British officials, the Foreign Office said on Sunday.

He would also meet the Secretary-General of the International Maritime Organisation (IMO) to discuss Pakistani crew members held by Somali pirates aboard the MT Honour 25 oil tanker, the FO said in a statement.

Indian national shot in NYC

NEW YORK: A 27-year-old Indian national was shot dead in New York City by an unidentified man after an altercation, according to a media report.

Gurdeep Singh, a resident of Queens, was fatally shot around 10 pm (local time) on Friday near Stanley Avenue in East New York neighbourhood. The suspect fled the scene after the incident. When the police reached the scene, they found a man who was shot in the chest.

Paramedics rushed the victim to a hospital, where he was pronounced dead, according to CBS News. News were scheduled from August 25-29. A surveillance video shows two people fighting in the street followed by a flash of light, assumed to be from gunshots. One person fell on the ground, and the other got in a car and drove off, the report said.

WHILE IRAN WARNS NEIGHBOURS OVER SANCTIONS

US memorandum is best path out of stalled war: Iranian President

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, August 23

Iran's president defended a memorandum of understanding with the United States as the best way out of a stalled war.

Meanwhile, the new head of the Islamic Republic's top security body warned, in a more forceful tone, of retaliation if neighbouring countries support US threats to further sanction Tehran. A Palestinian man was beaten by an Israeli settler outside his home, and Israel's military said they were pursuing a stabbing suspect in a separate attack, the latest violence in the occupied West Bank. An Israeli airstrike in Gaza killed a child, according to a local hospital.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian defended a recent memorandum of understanding as the best way for the



Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian

country to move beyond what he described as a situation of "neither war nor peace." "There is not a single provision in this agreement that amounts to capitulation," Pezeshkian said in a speech published by state-run IRNA early on Sunday. "The supreme leader sets the policies, and we will follow that path."

The deal known as the Memorandum of Under-

“THERE IS NOT A SINGLE PROVISION IN THIS PACT THAT AMOUNTS TO CAPITULATION

standing that US President Donald Trump signed in June set a 60-day deadline for end-

KEY POINTS

» Nearly six months into the war, Iran's economy is suffering under sanctions and a naval blockade

» Pezeshkian also linked the agreement to Iran's economic prospects

ing the war with Iran and reaching an accord on its nuclear program. That period ended last week, but no signs of compromise have emerged, especially on the crucial issue of reopening the Strait of Hormuz, vital to global shipping.

Pezeshkian also linked the agreement to Iran's economic prospects, saying the country couldn't attract investment in this stalled phase.

Nearly six months into

the war with the United States and Israel, Iran's economy is suffering under sanctions and a naval blockade.

The judiciary's Mizan news agency reported on Sunday the latest execution connected to the protests, identifying the man as Majid Adineh and saying he was arrested Jan. 9 in Mohammadshahr, near Karaj, west of Tehran. Authorities said that he was carrying a handgun with 30 rounds of ammunition, two stun guns, two cans of tear gas and a battery-powered chainsaw.

The judiciary said that forensic examinations indicated the handgun had been fired on Jan. 8 and 9. Mizan said Adineh had joined the unrest following calls by groups opposed to Iran's government and alleged that he had received training from groups outside the country.

Zelenskyy details rift with dismissed defence minister

The President says some of his actions were misguided



Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, August 23

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said he believes actions taken by dismissed Defence Minister Mykhailo Fedorov, including his involvement in mass protests and calls for elections, were misguided, as he publicly detailed their dispute for the first time.

Zelenskyy also alluded to problematic decisions over defence spending and said inaccurate information provided by the Defence Ministry contributed to an awkward encounter with US President Donald Trump over the use of Starlink in Russia.

Zelenskyy disclosed figures showing Ukraine's growing shortage of Patriot air-defence missiles needed to counter Russian ballistic attacks, with deliveries from Western allies declining in the past three years even as Russian missile strikes intensified.

He highlighted battlefield gains, however, saying Ukrainian forces have almost completely recaptured the

ZELENSKYY DISCLOSED FIGURES SHOWING UKRAINE'S SHORTAGE OF PATRIOT AIR-DEFENCE MISSILES NEEDED TO COUNTER RUSSIAN ATTACKS

Dnipropetrovsk region, with only about 10 square kilometres remaining under Russian control.

He made the remarks during a two-hour off-the-record meeting with reporters on Saturday, with a transcript released publicly on Sunday.

His comments ranged widely, covering the latest battlefield developments, efforts to counter Russian ballistic attacks, the state of peace negotiations, Ukraine's budgetary challenges and the political turmoil surrounding Fedorov's dismissal.

"I really had and still have a very positive attitude toward Mykhailo. We have been through a lot together. But I believe that he himself goes, or is pushed, into the wrong things," he said.

Moderate earthquake shakes Japan

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Tokyo August 23

A moderate earthquake rattled eastern Japan, including the Tokyo area, early Sunday, injuring more than 30 people, most of them lightly, officials said. There was no danger of a tsunami.

According to the Japan Meteorological Agency, the quake had a preliminary magnitude of 5.9.

Carney warned about economic coercion

Now US President Donald Trump is testing Canadian Prime Minister

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Toronto, August 23

Mark Carney drew international attention as Canada's prime minister by warning that middle powers must resist economic coercion by more powerful countries. Now President Donald Trump is putting that warning to the test with sweeping new tariffs that could show how much economic pain Canada can absorb.

Tensions escalated late Friday when Canada walked away from negotiations after Carney con-



Canadian PM Mark Carney with US President Donald Trump

FILE PHOTO

cluded the United States was demanding too much in exchange for tariff relief.

The US imposed 50 per cent duties Saturday on about \$20 billion worth

of Canadian goods, and Carney announced dollar-for-dollar retaliation beginning September 8.

Carney is doing what many other American allies have so far avoided: risking economic pain rather than yielding to tariff pressure.

For Carney, the show-down is the clearest test yet of his argument that middle powers must stand up to economic pressure from great powers such as the United States and China, even when it comes at a cost.

‘UK power plant shuts down after suspected cyber attack from Iran’

AGENCIES
London, August 23

A power plant in the United Kingdom was forced to shut down for at least four days after a cyberattack. While the British government has not disclosed details of the event, the attack is said to have been linked to Iran.

Based on a report by the Telegraph UK, the incident took place last month and is believed to be the most successful cyber attack in recent times. The report further added that the hacking of the power plant took place at the same time as a series of attacks on US water systems.

As per the BBC and Telegraph, the British government has not disclosed the name of the power

THE REPORT ADDED THAT THE HACKING OF THE POWER PLANT TOOK PLACE AT THE SAME TIME AS A SERIES OF ATTACKS ON US WATER SYSTEMS

plant affected due to security concerns.

However, it is believed that the plant impacted by the cyber attack was relatively small and had no impact on the wider power and energy supply in the UK. Iran has long been regarded as a capable cyber power and since the start of the conflict with the US in February, West-

ern cyber-security world has braced for attacks either from the state.

Suspected attacks have also been reported in Germany, Finland, Poland, Belgium and Albania, which have been linked to Iran. The GCHQ had previously urged businesses to be careful and brace for more such attacks.

"In light of rapidly evolving events in the Middle East, it is critical that all UK organisations remain alert to the potential risk of cyber compromise, particularly those with assets or supply chains that are in areas of regional tensions," Jonathan Ellison, the director for national resilience at the National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) said in a memo in March.

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Reno, August 23

The fast-growing Hawk Fire spread from the Sierra foothills toward the centre of Reno early Sunday, growing to more than 10,500 acres. Nearly 14,000 homes were ordered evacuated, and the "GO NOW" zone reached the edge of the University of Nevada campus.

Washoe County, Nevada emergency officials opened the Reno-Sparks Convention Centre to evacuees, but said they couldn't bring their pets - small animals and large animals were to be left at two other locations.

Gov. Joe Lombardo declared a state of emergency in Washoe County, and mobilised the Nevada National Guard



HIGHLIGHTS

» Washoe County, Nevada emergency officials opened the Reno-Sparks Convention Centre to evacuees

» Gov. Joe Lombardo declared a state of emergency in Washoe County

to support aerial firefighting with two helicopter crews

as well as 60 troops to help police safeguard evacuated

neighbourhoods.

The fire apparently began Saturday and grew significantly throughout the day, fueled by strong, gusty winds, low humidity and dry vegetation, according to a statement from Truckee Meadows Fire & Rescue, which joined the fight from just across the California state line.

SEEKS APPOINTMENT OF NODAL OFFICERS

Centre pushes states, UTs to speed up adoption of piped natural gas

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

The Petroleum Ministry has asked states and Union Territories to provide district-level administrative support to accelerate the shift of households from LPG to piped natural gas (PNG), seeking appointment of nodal officers to coordinate with city gas distributors (CGDs) & oil marketing companies (OMCs).

In an August 21 letter to state chief secretaries, Petroleum Secretary Neeraj Mittal said PNG, as a safer, cleaner and more efficient cooking fuel, has an important role in advancing India's energy transition while reducing the logistics burden associated with LPG distribution and improving consumer convenience.

"PNG brings a safer, cleaner and more efficient cooking fuel, playing a critical role in advancing the country's energy transition objectives. Its accelerated adoption contributes to reducing the logistics burden associated with LPG distribution, enhancing consumer convenience, and improving utilisation of CGD infrastructure cre-



ated through substantial public and private investment," Mittal said in the letter.

The ministry is seeking district-level intervention as it moves to implement a regulatory framework aimed at preventing households from retaining both LPG and PNG connections in areas where piped gas is available.

The push for faster adoption of PNG, follows the disruption to India's LPG supply chains during the West Asia crisis earlier this year.

LPG was among the fuels most exposed to the conflict because India imports a large share of its cooking-gas requirement, with much of those sup-

plies coming from Qatar, Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and Kuwait and moving through the Strait of Hormuz.

The disruption forced the government to prioritise domestic LPG supplies, with commercial and industrial consumers facing restrictions before supplies were progressively restored. India has since moved to diversify its LPG sourcing, including higher purchases from the US and Algeria, as it seeks to reduce its exposure to disruptions in Middle Eastern supplies.

Piped natural gas, by contrast, proved considerably more resilient during the crisis, particularly for domestic household consumers. Domestic PNG supplies received prior-

KEY POINTS

- » The push for faster adoption of gas piped to households, called PNG, follows the disruption to India's LPG supply chains during the West Asia crisis earlier this year
- » LPG was among the fuels most exposed to the conflict because India imports a large share of its cooking-gas requirement

ity allocation of domestically produced natural gas, insulating the segment from much of the disruption that affected imported LPG and LNG cargoes.

While industrial and commercial gas users with greater dependence on imported LNG faced some exposure, domestic PNG and CNG supplies were expected to remain largely unaffected. The experience has strengthened the case for expanding city-gas infrastructure and shifting households towards piped cooking fuel as part of a broader strategy to reduce India's dependence on imported LPG and make the country's energy system more resilient to geopolitical and

shipping disruptions.

To promote faster PNG adoption, the government has notified the Natural Gas and Petroleum Products Distribution (Through Laying, Building, Operation and Expansion of Pipelines and Other Facilities) Orders of 2026 and LPG Control Orders under Section 3 of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955.

The orders prohibit households from retaining simultaneous LPG and PNG connections and provide for discontinuation of LPG supply to households that fail to apply for a PNG connection despite due notice, wherever PNG supply is available, Mittal said in the letter. The ministry has directed authorised city gas distribution entities and public-sector OMCs to establish a PNG Coordination Committee (PCC) in every geographical area.

The committees will identify eligible housing societies & households, issue statutory notices to housing societies, resident welfare associations and individual consumers, and conduct outreach camps to accelerate PNG connections.

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, August 23

As mutual fund participation expands beyond traditional investor segments, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey has stressed the need for stronger governance and oversight, while calling for products, distribution and communication to adapt to the growing participation of first-time investors and people from smaller towns.

Speaking at the 31st foundation day of the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) in Mumbai, Pandey underlined the growing role of mutual funds in channelising household savings into the productive economy.

"Mutual funds perform a dual role - helping households participate in India's growth and channelling their savings into the productive economy," said Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman, SEBI.

He also cautioned that the expanding scale and complexity of the industry places a greater responsibility on fund managers and other stakeholders.

"The mutual fund indus-



SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey

try manages public money, which brings with it a special fiduciary responsibility. As the industry grows in scale and complexity, governance and oversight must keep pace," the SEBI Chairman said.

Pandey said the next phase of growth in the mutual fund sector would increasingly involve investors who have traditionally had lower participation in capital markets.

"The next generation of investors will increasingly come from smaller towns, first-time investors and under-represented segments. Products, distribution and communication must adapt accordingly," he said.

AMFI Chairman Sundeep Sikka said the industry now faces the challenge of taking the culture of disciplined and long-term

investing to a wider section of the country while building confidence among new and underserved investors.

"The opportunity now is to take this progress to a wider section of the country by strengthening investor awareness, expanding access and building greater confidence among first-time and underserved investors," said Sundeep Sikka, Chairman, Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI).

AMFI Chief Executive Venkat N. Chalasani said simplicity, accessibility and trust would be critical if mutual funds were to become relevant to a broader section of households.

"For mutual funds to become truly relevant to every household, investing must be simple, accessible, trustworthy and aligned with everyday financial needs," said Venkat N. Chalasani, Chief Executive, AMFI. Chalasani also highlighted the role of distributors in expanding the industry's reach, while stressing that growth should not come at the expense of responsible conduct.

Gold, silver likely to retain growth momentum this week

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 23

Gold and silver prices are expected to retain their upward momentum this week, though profit-bookings at higher levels may temper the rally as investors await key US inflation data, analysts said. US Core Personal Consumption Expenditures (PCE) inflation and GDP figures will be the key triggers for bullion.

Developments surrounding West Asia geopolitics, particularly the US-Iran peace deal and reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, will also remain in focus, they added.

On the domestic front, gold futures for October delivery gained Rs 7,932, or 5.13 per cent, to close the week at Rs 1.62 lakh per 10 grams on the MCX.

Silver for September delivery surged Rs 10,673, or 4.52 per cent, to settle at Rs 2.46 lakh per kilogram.

In global markets, Comex gold futures for December delivery rose \$243.3, or 5.5 per cent, to close at \$4,680.6/ounce. Silver futures for September delivery climbed \$4.42, or nearly 7 per cent, to \$69.53/ounce in New York.

Commerce Secy to embark on 3-nation visit to South America

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, August 23

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal will undertake a three-nation visit to South America from August 24-28, government sources said on Sunday.

During the visit, Agrawal will chair joint trade committee meetings with Brazil and Argentina, before travelling to Chile to advance talks on upgrading the India-Chile Preferential Trade Agreement (PTA) into a full FTA.

Officials indicated the Chile FTA negotiations

are at an advanced stage, with only a few outstanding issues left to resolve. "This is an effort to see how far we can move, because the idea is we are very close. There are only a few issues which are left to be resolved," a government source said.

The sticking points largely revolve around market access and critical minerals. "The issues are related to market access and also some critical minerals; we are trying to see where we can balance these two discussions," the source added.

While Chile is pushing for deeper access to the Indian market, India is seeking greater engagement on critical minerals from the resource-rich nation.

South America is increasingly being viewed by New Delhi as a key market for trade diversification. Sources said India is also keen to engage with the MERCOSUR bloc comprising Brazil, Argentina, Paraguay, Uruguay and Bolivia for an expanded PTA, with terms of reference for the arrangement currently under discussion.

Under-30 traders account for 43% of derivatives market participants in FY26, says Sebi study

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 23

India's equity derivatives market is witnessing a significant shift towards younger participants, with traders below 30 accounting for 43 per cent of individual participants in FY2025-26, up sharply from 31 per cent four years earlier, according to a Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) study.

However, younger traders also recorded a higher incidence of losses. About 89 per cent of traders below 30 were loss-makers

in FY26, compared with 81 per cent of participants above 60.

The changing age profile is part of a broader transformation in the retail derivatives market, which is increasingly attracting investors from smaller cities and lower-income groups.

About three-fourths of individual derivatives traders had annual incomes below Rs 5 lakh.

This group accounted for 43 per cent of turnover but 53 per cent of aggregate losses.

Around 88 per cent

of traders in this income bracket incurred losses, compared with 81 per cent of investors earning above Rs 1 crore annually.

The study also highlighted the growing geographical spread of derivatives participation. Investors from smaller towns, classified as B30 locations, accounted for about two-thirds of individual traders and nearly half of derivatives turnover in FY26.

Sebi noted that Investors from smaller towns account for only about one-fourth of individ-

ual mutual fund assets, indicating a significantly higher appetite for derivatives risk compared with their broader investment behaviour.

The study further examined derivatives participation against the size of investors' underlying equity portfolios.

In FY2025-26, around 95 lakh, or 78 per cent, of individual derivatives traders had equity portfolios below Rs 1 lakh.

This segment accounted for 51 per cent of turnover but as much as 70 per cent of aggregate losses.

SBI MF's equity SIF NFO mobilises ₹1,154 cr

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, August 23

SBI Mutual Fund announced the successful closure of the New Fund Offer (NFO) of Magnum Equity Ex-Top 100 Long Short Fund, its second investment strategy under the Magnum SIF (Specialized Investment Fund) offering.

The NFO closed on August 20, 2026, mobilising Rs 1,154 crore - the highest NFO mobilisation so far in the Equity SIF category.

It is an open-ended investment strategy pre-

dominantly investing in equity and equity related instruments including limited short exposure in equity through derivative instruments, of stocks other than large cap stocks.

The investment objective of the strategy is to generate long-term capital appreciation by investing primarily in equity and equity-related instruments of stocks outside the Top 100 by market capitalization, while utilizing limited short exposure through derivatives to enhance returns and/or manage risk.

There is no assurance that the investment objective of the Investment strategy will be achieved.

The New Fund Offer, which was open for subscription from August 7 to August 20, 2026, received strong investor interest, reflecting growing awareness and acceptance of the SIF framework and the demand for differentiated investment strategies that seek to participate in market opportunities while managing portfolio volatility.

Debasish Mishra, MD

& CEO, SBI Funds Management Limited, said: "The strong response to the Magnum Equity Ex-Top 100 Long Short Fund NFO reflects investors' growing interest in differentiated risk strategies and also their trust in our research-led capabilities across the market."

We will continue to build a diversified suite of investment strategies under our Magnum SIF brand that serve investors with clarity and conviction and help them get greater flexibility in portfolio construction, he added.

IIFCL initiates \$1.8 billion ECB fund-raising programme

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 23

State-owned India Infrastructure Finance Company Ltd (IIFCL) has kick-started its \$1.8 billion External Commercial Borrowing (ECB) fund-raising programme by mobilising \$200 million through international markets.

The mobilisation marks the first milestone in IIFCL's broader international fund-raising programme,

following government approval to raise about \$1.8 billion through ECBs, the company said in a statement on Sunday.

The company is pursuing opportunities across international financial markets with a focus on competitive pricing, prudent risk management and mobilisation of long-term resources to support India's infrastructure financing requirements.

As part of the programme, IIFCL is envis-

aging raising about \$1 billion through long-term ECBs, with tenors of up to 15 years, under the MIGA Guarantee Facility, in multiple tranches, it said.

The Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA), a world Bank Group arm, provides guarantees against non-commercial risks to facilitate the flow of foreign investment in developing countries and lift people out of poverty.

'Geopolitics & oil prices to drive mkts this week'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 23

Crude oil prices and developments in the US-Iran conflict will remain the primary factors influencing stock market movements this week, according to analysts.

"Investors will closely monitor the Jackson Hole symposium, particularly comments from the US Federal Reserve Chairman, for indications on the future trajectory of interest rates. US GDP estimates, durable goods orders and consumer confidence will also provide important



clues on the strength of the US economy and the Fed's policy outlook," Ajit Mishra - SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

On the domestic front, investors will track rupee movement, foreign institutional flows and domestic liquidity conditions, he added.

SEBI, NSE promote financial literacy, investor awareness at Nehru Trophy Boat Race

Campaign focused on investor rights, financial planning

AGENCIES
Alappuzha, August 23

The SEBI and the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE), along with other securities market participants, organised an Investor Awareness Pavilion at the Nehru Trophy Boat Race 2026 on August 22 at Punnamad Lake in Alappuzha, Kerala.

The boat race was inaugurated by Kerala Chief Minister V D Satheesan and

Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar.

The joint SEBI-NSE pavilion was inaugurated by Alappuzha District Collector Shaji V Nair, Ernakulam Range DIG Yathish Chandra GH and Alappuzha District Police Chief SP Vishnu Pratheep TK, in the presence of SEBI General Manager MK Srikanth and NSE Senior Vice President Avishkar Naik.

The NSE said the initia-

tive drew parallels between the boat race and financial discipline, highlighting teamwork, discipline, patience and informed decision-making as common elements.

The campaign focused on investor rights and responsibilities, financial planning, SEBI-verified applications, grievance redressal and identifying investment frauds and scams.

Visitors at the pavilion

received simplified investor education materials and engaged in interactive learning tools such as Spin the Wheel, the "Scam No" game, Awareness Darts, Protection Baskets, and Invest Safe Ludo.

The initiative also brought market infrastructure institutions and associations together for query resolution and complaint facilitation, targeting first-time investors, young adults and families.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

Railway Board Additional Member (Production Units) Sunil Kumar inspects production facilities at Rail Coach Factory, Kapurthala, on August 22, 2026, accompanied by RCF General Manager Ajay Nandan and senior officials. He reviewed coach manufacturing, MEMU and Bangladesh Railway rakes, and Vande Bharat trainset bogie units, emphasising quality, safety, innovation and timely production targets.

INDIA SCORE 300/5 AT STUMPS ON DAY 1 OF 2ND TEST AGAINST SL

Padikkal hits second ton in a row

Each of KL Rahul, Jaiswal and Gill had a similar opportunity but failed to kick-on

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Colombo, August 23

Devdutt Padikkal conjured an extraordinary 117, powering India above Rishabh Pant's hand injury and untimely fall of wickets around him to a reasonable 300 for five on the opening day of second and final Test against spirited Sri Lanka here on Sunday. Dhruv Jurel (7) and debutant Saransh Jain (4) were batting at close after a taxing day of Test cricket. Padikkal's 168-ball innings, his second hundred in as many Tests, was not laced with the customary elegance barring on a couple of occasions when he brought out those full-blooded pulls and drives. He was dropped on 0 and 1 but remained solid after those reprieves. But the innings was still stunning because of the circumstances in which it was executed. Yashasvi Jaiswal (45) and skipper Shubman Gill



Devdutt Padikkal in action

(50), with whom he constructed a stabilising 120-run stand for the third wicket, were dismissed after raising visions of bigger knocks. Pant copped a blow on his forearm from pacer Lahiru Kumara and had

to retire hurt on 3, leaving Padikkal to do the heavy lifting. Then there were the constantly examining Sri Lankan bowlers and the scorching heat and humidity of Colombo for him to tide over.

It was not that the Karnataka man had oodles of experience on his back to fall back upon to counter such tough situations. Padikkal was playing just the fourth Test of his nascent career but the cir-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Dhruv Jurel (7) and debutant Saransh Jain (4) were batting at close after a taxing day of Test cricket
- » The innings was still stunning because of the circumstances in which it was executed
- » This century was vastly different from the one he scored at Galle, where the pitch was not remotely challenging in the first two days

cumstances forced him to play the lead firefighter's role. This century was vastly different from the one he scored at Galle, where the pitch was not remotely challenging in the first two days. But the SSC deck offered enough bounce and bite, especially for pacers, asking constant questions about his technique and patience.

Edmund hat-trick fires East Bengal to 17th Durand Cup title



East Bengal players celebrate with the tournament trophy after winning the Durand Cup 2026 Final match against MBSG, in Kolkata

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kolkata, August 23

Edmund Lalrindika struck a dream derby hat-trick as a compact East Bengal produced a scintillating show to rout Mohun Bagan 4-1 and clinch a record-equalling 17th Durand Cup title here on Sunday.

It also ended the Red and Gold's 22-year wait for the trophy, having last won in 2004 with a 2-1 win over Mohun Bagan. The Antonio Lopez Habas-coached side were at their fluid best, with skipper Mohammed Rashid holding the midfield and orchestrating their attacks, as East Bengal handed their arch-rivals a nightmare start by scoring four goals in a breathtaking first half.

Rashid set up Bipin Singh's opener in the 10th minute and later assisted Lalrindika's hat-trick goal in the 44th minute. Playing as a lone forward in place of Jesin TK, Lalrindika also struck in the 12th and 22nd minutes as East Bengal virtually bur-

IT ALSO ENDED THE RED AND GOLD'S 22-YEAR WAIT FOR THE TROPHY

ied their arch-rivals' hopes in an action-packed first half. Manvir Singh pulled one back for Mohun Bagan in the 33rd minute, providing a solitary moment of joy for the Mariners. But the reigning Indian Super League champions remained compact and disciplined to see out the match and exact revenge for their 0-1 defeat in the 2023 final that had given Mohun Bagan a record 17th title. The result means the two city heavyweights are now even-stevens, with 17 Durand Cup titles apiece in the 135-year history of the Asia's oldest competition.

It was a dream start from the Habas's men as East Bengal virtually sealed Mohun Bagan's fate before the half-hour mark, with the Red and Gold Brigade running riot in a pulsating first half. Bipin opened the scor-

ing in the 10th minute with a composed left-footed finish. Captain Rashid won possession in the opposition half, shaped as if to shoot before slipping the ball through to Bipin, who calmly drilled his effort from inside the box past Vishal Kaith. Before Mohun Bagan could regroup, East Bengal struck again. Edmund doubled the lead, bursting forward on the counter before unleashing a powerful 20-yard effort that took a deflection off Kaith and nestled into the net. Edmund was at it again in the 22nd minute, this time finishing into an empty net. Hardik Bhatt picked up the ball on the left and fed Daniel Ramirez, who threaded it through to Lalrindika. The striker took a touch into the box, rounded the advancing Kaith with another touch and slotted into the unguarded goal. The captain was involved once again as Rashid delivered a teasing cross to the far side of the box, where Jay Gupta arrived at pace.

Badminton: French pair Gicquel-Delrue creates history

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 23

Thom Gicquel and Delphine Delrue scripted history on Sunday, becoming France's first-ever badminton World Champions after stunning world No. 1 pair Feng Yan Zhe and Huang Dong Ping in the mixed doubles final here.



The world No. 5 French pair overcame their Chinese opponents 22-20, 19-21, 21-15 in one hour and 18 minutes to claim the big-

gest title of their careers. Bronze medalists at the last edition, Gicquel and Delrue produced a tactical masterclass, particularly at the net, where they successfully neutralised Huang's influence. The French duo had shown strong form in the lead-up to the World Championships, finishing runners-up at the All England Championships and

reaching the semi-finals at the Indonesia and China Super 1000 tournaments earlier this year. Another French player is on the cusp of history, with ninth seed Alex Lanier set to face Japan's Kodai Naraoka in the men's singles final. Lanier will bid to become the first Frenchman to win the men's singles world title.

FILM

Jon Turteltaub confirms 'National Treasure 3'



LOS ANGELES: Filmmaker Jon Turteltaub said the makers are developing 'National Treasure 3'. Turteltaub was at an event when he went on to speak about

the film. In the videos surfaced online, the filmmaker said 'Disney' has approved the script for the project. "I was thinking about mentioning this tonight. I'll say it tonight... It's happening. You're the first people I have said this out loud to," he is heard saying in the video. "It is finally real. Now, it's 'Hollywood real', meaning things can happen. Nic gets hit by a bus; there's no 'National Treasure'. If I get hit by a bus, there's probably a 'National Treasure'. Welcome to Hollywood, that's Hollywood... We finally have a script that I like," he added. The first instalment featured Nicolas Cage as Benjamin Franklin Gates.

Don't take cinema too seriously: Yash

The Telugu pre-release event of 'Toxic' in Hyderabad was not just a film celebration - it was a stage for Yash to speak about cinema, dreams and unity. The actor spoke about the increasing reach of Indian cinema and thanked the Telugu audiences for their constant support while addressing a large gathering of students and fans. He said talent and hard work could overcome the barriers of language and geography to unite people. Yash started his speech by thanking the Telugu audience for all the love they have given him in his career. He added that the Indian film industry has given people the confidence to dream bigger. Yash stressed that audiences don't look at language or regional boundaries when they see genuine effort. "If anyone works with honesty and passion, the viewers will always support them. They are not biased. They are very honest and truthful," he said. He further described cinema as a space where there should be no barriers.



JHC commemorates Jamaica's 64th anniversary of Independence

A celebration of Jamaica's heritage, culture & enduring friendship with India brought together diplomacy, music and cuisine in the capital

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 23

The High Commission of Jamaica in New Delhi commemorated Jamaica's 64th Anniversary of Independence with an evening that brought together diplomacy, culture and the unmistakable spirit of the island nation. The celebration welcomed members of the diplomatic corps, senior government representatives, distinguished guests, hundreds of Jamaicaphiles and friends of Jamaica, while also marking the enduring friendship between Jamaica and India. The occasion was graced by Minister of State for External Affairs and Textiles, Pabitra Margherita, H.E. Mayank Joshi, High Commissioner of India to Jamaica, alongside other



High Commissioners and Ambassadors resident in Delhi, Members of Parliament, government representatives and members of the Consular and Diplomatic Corps. Hosted by H.E. Jason K M Hall, High Commissioner of Jamaica to India, the celebration captured what he described as the warmth, hospitality, love and 'rid-dim' of Jamaica. Guests experienced a vibrant slice of the country through authentic Jamaican cuisine, world-renowned Jamaican Blue Mountain Coffee, premium Jamaican rum and live music, including performances by Jamaican singular vocalist Hezron, Soul Rebel and the BGM Band, adding to the vibrant cultural character of the evening. Chef Richie Richards, Managing Partner of Miss Lily's, Dubai, was especially present for the celebration to present a selection of

delectable Jamaican dishes to guests. His participation added a direct culinary link to Jamaica and complemented the evening's focus on bringing the country's rich food culture to New Delhi. Reflecting on Jamaica's journey, H.E. Hall highlighted the significance of 'Emancipence' - the period between Emancipation Day on August 1 and Independence Day on August 6 - as a celebration not only of freedom, but of the resilience and sacrifice that made it possible. Speaking on the occasion, H.E. Jason K M Hall said, "That we are where we are today and that Jamaica has achieved what it has after centuries of hardship, is owed to the sacrifice and indomitable spirit of those who came before us. As the black, green and gold flies 64 years after Independence, it represents not simply our freedom, but a

THE EVENING ALSO RECOGNISED THE WIDER SIGNIFICANCE OF AUGUST AS A MONTH OF INDEPENDENCE AND NATIONAL MILESTONES FOR SEVERAL NATIONS REPRESENTED IN INDIA

Jamaica that continues to compete, contribute and excel on the world stage." The High Commissioner also reflected on the historic relationship between Jamaica and India, a friendship that extends beyond formal diplomatic relations to the arrival of Indians in Jamaica nearly two centuries ago. Generations of Jamaicans of Indian descent have since become an integral part of the country's social and cultural fabric, creating a living connection between the two nations. Over the past few years, this relationship has gained further momentum through high-level exchanges, expanding trade and cultural engagement and cooperation across healthcare, food and energy security, climate resilience, capacity building and disaster preparedness. H.E. Hall also acknowledged India's continued role as an impor-

tant development partner, including its support following natural disasters and its broader leadership on resilient infrastructure and renewable energy. He further highlighted the growing relevance of India-led global initiatives such as the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI) and the International Solar Alliance (ISA) for Small Island Developing States such as Jamaica, which remain particularly vulnerable to the increasing frequency and intensity of climate-related disasters. The evening also recognised the wider significance of August as a month of independence and national milestones for several nations represented in India, celebrating the shared values of sovereignty, resilience and self-determination. With Jamaica and India connected by democratic values, culture, music, cricket, people-to-people ties and an increasingly ambitious bilateral partnership, the 64th Independence celebration looked both backwards with gratitude and forward with optimism. As music took over for the remainder of the evening, the celebration moved seamlessly from diplomacy to Jamaican hospitality, a spirited expression of the country's enduring message to India: a friendship rooted in history.